ACHIEVE GREATNESS

NUTRITION



BOOK 1

Achieve Greatness (Training Edition)

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How To Achieve Greatness In Your Nutrition

The next thing we are going to work into your positive daily routine is **nutrition.**

Once you master the concepts of nutrition, and combine healthy eating with all the self-improvement techniques in the previous chapter, you will notice life start to improve.

A great diet can affect your ***mood***, your hormones, your ability to get the body you want, your ability to focus to get work done.

A great diet can allow you to perceive yourself as someone who is filling

your body with goodness, which gives you a greater level of **self-respect**.

With a **great mood** and level of focus, everything in your life becomes more **productive, positive and easier**.

I am going to take **everything** I learned about diet as a personal trainer and show you everything with nothing left out.

You may be feeling the urge to skip this chapter. Maybe you **already** eat very healthily, or maybe you are one of those young people that just want to hit the weights hard and not focus on this stuff.

But I ***promise*** you that if you take a simple hour to read this chapter, it

will be one of the most valuable hours you ever spent.

There are a few things you ***NEED*** to get right, or that 2 year 6 pack or hourglass figure you think you are going to get, will take 4 or 5 years.

Being educated on a diet even to a fitness instructor level, will take you **way beyond** what most people know about diet.

Once you know the **general** principles, you have an education that stays with you for life, and you will never listen to social media, or what anyone else says, you will just confidently make the ***correct*** choices that you know are healthy and will lead to the body and health of your dreams.

I'm going to take you in **less than an hour** to knowing more than 90% of people about nutrition.

If you have ever wondered what a qualified personal trainer knows about nutrition, or if this has ever been a missing link or weak spot in your gym education, then I really urge you to give this chapter a read.

It will be the ***best*** thing you could do, it is a worthwhile use of your time to take an hour and learn the ins and outs of nutrition today, so no one will be able to tell you otherwise or lead you down the wrong path.

We will cover all the diets you see today, and explain the **best** practices.

An Introduction To Nutrition

I can't stress enough that I saw next to **no changes** until I got the Nutrition aspect of my training **correct.** Your diet makes up more than 50% of a good body.

The first **two phrases** I ever heard that were taught in my PT nutrition class were:

"You can't out train a bad diet."

And:

"You are what you eat."

And for **great reason.**

Your diet **absolutely** needs to be on point so that you feel good everyday, with extreme motivation and a lot of energy. When you consistently feel great instead of **drained** and **tired**, the effect adds up day by day and gives you what you need to unlock that 100% within you.

I believe without a good knowledge of diet, you will make next to no quality gains, and fall out of motivation so often, but with a strong foundation, you will progress and train daily and never have such issues!

Helping Others With Nutrition

Food and nutrition are often very sensitive subjects because beliefs can be so **ingrained**. It's difficult for anyone to accept that what they've always believed may be wrong, even if there's strong evidence, such as poor health or being significantly overweight, to suggest otherwise.

Personal Trainers are actually told to approach Nutrition very **sensitively** and there are **limitations** to what we can do. If you are training someone, whether you are a Personal Trainer or not, you can give general advice to generally healthy people.

For example you can give **meal structures** for generally healthy people such as: *"Here's an example day of eating that supports fat loss and training."*

You can give example meal plans, and show them how you eat, and tell them tips that you know about nutrition.

However, you cannot "*prescribe*" someone a meal plan. Be very careful with using **that** word. Only qualified nutritionists can do this.

As long as you do not "prescribe" anyone anything when it comes to nutrition, you can safely **advise** them, but let them know you are just giving them an example and you are not prescribing them anything.

Another thing is that if you come across a person who asks for dietary advice who is trying to tackle eating disorders, asking for custom made diets for illnesses, then you must refer them to a nutritional **professional**.

We all want to help people, and as we improve at fitness others will **notice** our improvements and try to **ask for our help**, but it is best to know the limits of what we are qualified to do.

When it comes to generally healthy people, you CAN show them how to eat to improve their fitness, and provide them with educational examples and templates, but be sure to recommend that this is not "**doctor prescribed**" advice.

Tell them to see a dietician if they want a **medically** prescribed, custom diet plan that reflects their blood tests and any medical issue they may have.

So how can a Nutrition chapter help?

Nutritional information can help you whether you are:

A person who **coaches** others.

A person who is **advising** someone in their life who is generally healthy, who looks up to them for advice.

A person who wants to learn nutrition principles for their own training.

Why Learn Nutrition From A PT / This Book?

There is so much nonsense out there today… people say things like:

"Eggs are as bad for you as smoking."

"Hot lemon water and honey every morning lost me 5kg in 2 weeks."

"I went on a diet of grapefruit only and gained 5kg of muscle."

You will fall for all these cheap tricks… unless you know the science. The science doesn't take long to learn (maybe an hour at best) and stays with you for life!

Once you know the science, you will not fall for any of this **nonsense**, because you will get the inner feeling that it is against everything you were taught here in these pages.

These fitness magazines, these online influencers, they are driven by **money**. The easiest way to make money is to promise a "new system."

They want to sell you a system or method that no one has seen before. They want this system they sell you to be **exciting, sound cool, and be unique to them.**

So they go against the common advice that actually works, and instead come up with unique, slightly exciting and strange sounding things that **sound** cool.

If something looks or sounds cool, and seems new, against the current system, and is presented as a magical new opportunity to achieve a persons fitness goals, then it will make **money**.

It doesn't matter to the person selling it to you if it is **harmful**. These diet techniques often **are**. These techniques are often designed to be "just believable enough" to where you will believe them and not think to research or question them.

The difference between what I teach and the **nonsense** diets, is that in all honesty, the plan for healthy eating is pretty clear and hasn't changed much over the years.

Some of my advice isn't exactly what the government suggests, because the government tend to recommend the "minimum effective dose" for a lot of things. And I like to push clients hard to do more than the "minimum" when it comes to their eating habits and fitness programmes.

But, if you compare the **majority** of my advice against the general medical guidelines available, and the modern scientific studies, there is nothing in this book that seems too out of line.

The difference is people nowadays don't know where to get their information anymore or simply don't care.

Nowadays people would rather view and use their smartphones and social

media as search engines, rather than reading proper medical journals or information behind things, because it is easier.

No one really wants to read a medical or scientific journal, or do a fitness course. Nowadays, there is things like AI which can fact check things in seconds. But people **still** don't seem to care to do the actual research.

There is so much **contradictory** information available as to what constitutes a balanced diet which is what confuses people.

Many people are confused and have no **real idea** what they should be eating.

The media doesn't help and most newspapers and magazines happily champion the latest fad diet, seemingly oblivious to the fact that they are **contradicting** the information that they provided previously.

I still remember being a teenager, **naturally gifted** at sports, whose performance was dropping. I had no idea it was my poor diet and the food in the house that surrounded me, and the choices I made that led to this drop in performance.

Learning the **right way** from a qualified person will really help you to understand where you are going wrong.

It will save you a lot of time in your fitness journey and maximise your results if you learn this stuff quickly.

Nutrition is **50% of a good looking & functioning body.**
You WILL NOT see gains if this is **not** dialled in.

Good nutrition is the difference between our minds, mood and our bodies operating at 100% capacity or at 20% capacity.

The ***mood boost*** that good nutrition gives you can make all the difference. It can be the difference between a lifetime of you feeling sluggish, demotivated and giving up on your training every few months.

And actually **hitting** your goals, feeling a clean and healthy feeling, feeling a boost in your mood so great and significant that you WANT to train, you want to expel this energy that you are so full of, and so this means you have **barely any** inconsistency in your gym periods.

When I eat well, provided I am also doing my mindset activities, the boost to my mood is so great that, I always WANT to go to the gym. I can go for months and even years and stay consistent when it counts.

Whenever I don't eat well and get fat, the gym becomes a chore. I don't want to go as much.

You really do get more energy to go to the gym.

Don't Listen To Just Anyone When It Comes To Diet

When I say diet is around 50% of your physique, it is not an exaggeration. So don't allow such an important part of your training to be led astray or anything less than ***scientifically informed.***

The best thing you can do when it comes to learning about nutrition and how it relates to fitness, in my opinion is to listen to a **qualified** PT, who has used nutrition to get into in great shape, who clearly advocates for a balanced diet and who teaches you the science to back up their claims.

You can review information anyone tells you now with the help of **AI tools**

on your search engine, and whilst AI is not perfect, it can give you a reasonable idea if the information you are suggested is harmful or not.

Take a look and learn the commonly suggested harmful diets in the later chapters, and fact check any nutritional advice with the national health services of your location, you can again use AI for this to see how any advice lines up with the science.

Beyond that, listen to how someone speaks when they try to give you nutritional information.

Do they explain the scientific reason why they make a suggestion? You will get a feel for them and how they talk.

Myself, for example, I believe it comes across in the advice I give and how I talk that I know things that the average person just wouldn't know about nutrition.

If a person starts talking about how specific food affects you and can tell you scientifically how it can affect your body, your hormones and your overall mood, then they seem more believable.

This is a good sign, but even then, people are able to say things in a way that sounds so confident and real that you believe it without checking the facts.

I want you to try really hard to fact check all your information before

following someone just because they have a six pack.

You will find the information in my Nutrition section to be in line with what I was taught in a recognised Personal Training fitness qualification and the facts align well with modern science.

Never accept: “oh, I heard it does this from a magazine or from an Instagram.” You need to look deeper to make better decisions.

When you carry out these checks and someone’s actually talking facts consistently, it’s a good sign.

Once you read the information in this section, I suggest you take the

recommended healthy shopping list I provide, and start to follow it.

And if anyone ever says anything to you that doesn't sound quite right to you, you are probably right to have a concern. Trust your instincts, and you can always come back to this chapter to refresh yourself on the facts.

What Is A Balanced Diet?

The word "balanced" implies that all food groups should be included and that the exclusion of any food groups (for example carbohydrates or fats) would lead to an unbalanced diet. We should aim to get a ***balanced*** diet with lots of clean food and "clean eating".

What is Eating Clean?

To put it very **simply**, eating clean is eating foods that are considered healthy. These foods are considered by the health and fitness community to be good clean foods.

Vegetables, low calorie foods, fitness foods, high protein foods, non processed, organic low fat meats, and non refined carbohydrates.

This is the opposite of high fat, high sugar, high calorie foods with next to no nutritional value and lots of processing done to the food. When a client asks me the number one reason for eating clean, I tell them this:

"Eating 1500 calories a day of dirty food, is not going to get you the same

looking body as eating 1500 calories a day of clean, high protein food."

Your body when eating clean food will be ripped, in shape and firm. You hit your protien target whilst keeping calories low, which keeps you in shape.

If you consume the same amount of calories but choose to consume them in junk food, you will not hit your protein targets that day, without bringing your calories too high and over time this will lead to your body becoming softer, weaker, and with low amounts of muscle mass.

Your skin will get greasy, and your overall look will not be the same. Clean, lean, foods that the body can use for power and growth will pack

more of a punch in your daily calories goals than filling your goals with foods that destroy your body."

The phrase "you are what you eat" is extremely true here. Hit your calorie **targets** with clean, high protein foods, and your body will look amazing.

9 times out of 10 your body will would look better with 1500 calories of clean eating, versus 2000 calories of junk foods.

This will be explained later in further chapters, but even when you bulk and cut, it is wise to do so in a **clean** way. A mistake I see so often is in gym newcomers who read about protein, then work out their protein target.

For example, let's use 150grams (as an example). A newcomer would workout their protein target was 150 grams, and then eat every burger in sight trying to hit that target.

They forget about eating clean. They get told by their parents to "eat lots for their muscles to grow big and strong."

But there is a **difference**, hitting that 150grams of protein with 1500calories of clean food, is going to bring about a much **better looking** body, than hitting 150grams of protein with 3000 calories of junk.

3000 calories of junk will get you **fat** before it gets you strong, putting you into a zone where your body cannot

use hormones effectively to build muscle!

Clean food is **powerful** & **useful** food that your body will actually use to get results. You will see a night and day difference.

Advice For Eating Clean Food

- Buy *organic foods* whenever possible.
- Use whole, fresh produce.
- Bake at home so you can choose the ingredients.
- Use lean cuts of meat with low fat percentages.
- Do not replace naturally occurring sugar with artificial

sweeteners, use natural sugars like raw honey.
- Use spray oils when cooking to use less calories.
- Avoid fried foods.
- Do not over consume calories, stick to the minimum that allows you to hit your protein targets and build muscle in the gym.

What is Eating Dirty?

Eating dirty is simply when someone does not eat in a healthy way. It's not just eating too much food, but it is choosing to eat many foods that ***do not benefit our health***, in ***unhealthy amounts.***

I will give you a quick avoid list to help you avoid falling into this trap:

Avoid the following:

- Processed Foods
- Fast foods
- Confectionary
- Soft Drinks & Cordials
- Pre Packaged Meals
- Refined Baked Goods
- High Sugar Foods
- Cheap Sausages Or Burgers
- High Fat Cuts Of Meat

Artificial Flavors - Whilst it is hard to cut them out entirely, it is wise to educate yourself on the fact that while officially additives are deemed to be safe when consumed in small

amounts, around 30 additives are known to be harmful in large doses.

As they are a relatively new addition to our food, their long term effects on health and well being remain largely unknown. For this reason alone it is wise to limit your consumption of artificial sweeteners and ingredients.

Water Intake

Water is **essential** for life, humans can survive only a **few days** without it. The average target is **2L per day** split between **8 x 250ml** glasses.

Shoot for **water only** as **caffeine** or **alcohol** will act as a **diuretic** and **dehydrate** you.

The best practice is to stick to **pure water** for 2L first, and then anything else can be additional to that.

You can buy one of those **1L bottles with markers on them**, and drink 1L first thing in the morning, and the other 1L throughout the day.

A coaching tip I can give you is that I've found it **easier** to fill up your 1L bottle 2 times in a day, rather than remembering and tracking 8 glasses of water a day.

Water can be really important when we are trying to **cut weight**. This is because a lot of the time when we feel hungry we are actually just thirsty.

When we keep ourselves full with water, we feel less desire to eat (in theory anyway, I have found it to hold true)

Aim to drink ***6-8 glasses of fluid every day.***

Water, lower-fat milk and sugar-free drinks including tea and coffee **all count.** Fruit juice and smoothies can be counted towards your fluid consumption, although they are a source of free sugars* and so you should limit consumption to no more than a combined total of 150ml per day.

Sugary drinks are one of the main contributors to excess sugar consumption amongst children and adults in the UK.

Swap sugary soft drinks for **diet, sugar-free or no added sugar** varieties to reduce your sugar intake in a simple step.

If you are **bodybuilding** the **2L** is actually a **minimum**. Take your weight, and search Athlean X Water Calculator on the Internet to find out how much you really need to be drinking.

Our muscles are **75% water**, and they need water to look full. With a deficient amount, your body will not reach its full potential as a bodybuilder.

It will be hard and you will need to use the toilet a lot in the first few days, but after some time your kidneys will adapt to your new water intake and it will become easy.

2 Portions Of Fish

Fish contain higher amounts of **protein** per 100g, with a unique "flaky" muscle structure that makes it easier

to digest and allows your body to absorb and retain more of its protein compared to other meats.

Oily fish provides **omega fatty acids** which are crucial for maintaining heart health, supporting **brain** and nervous
system function, and regulating hormones.

Aim for at least **two portions** (2 x 140g) of fish a week, including a portion of oily fish.

All The Vitamins And When To Take Them

Iron - Take them if you get fatigued often after a workout. A sound diet containing adequate iron ensures that there are plenty of RBCs – too few can result in anaemia which is characterised by fatigue and poor exercise performance.***Magnesium*** - Take this in the evening time to boost your sleep and help with hormones.

Cod Liver Oil - Take it in the morning for brain power. Use specifically cod liver oil because it has more vitamins than the standard “omega 3” pills, which amplify the results by a reasonable amount.

Vitamin D3 and K2 - Take 5,000 - 10,000 iu of vitamin D3 per day. Try and get a brand of tablets with some vitamin K2 inside to help the absorption of vitamin D3. This supports your testosterone hormones. Best taken in the **morning** with some fats.

Vitamin C - You can take this in the morning, either by buying the tablets that dissolve into water and give it an orange flavour, but I sometimes go to the store and buy the really cheap canned "mandarin segments."

These are really good for reducing the chances of getting ill. I rarely get ill because my intake is so high, and this allows me to be consistent with the gym and work.

Zinc - Many people suffer this deficiency. Take in the morning to help with testosterone and skin.

Evening Primrose Oil - This is a supplement for women. Not technically a vitamin, but a supplement. This helps women optimise their hormones as they deal with periods. It can help the skin, mood, and efficiency of the body during period cycles to help them stay more consistent.

Creatine - Creatine is not a vitamin but an important supplement. Creatine actually improves brain power so it is great alongside the cod liver oil. You will boost your short term memory and ability to focus.

Not only that but it improves your strength in the gym by increasing the water that goes into your muscles. It has next to no side effects. I have 5g every morning.

Vitamin B12 - Helps with energy and focus. Great if you feel tired and have low energy.

Vitamin B6 - Also helps with mood, and with energy. Great if you feel tired and have low energy. Mangos contain vitamin B6 and are known as the happy fruit as they boost your mood.

Please note that there are a few vitamins that you want to avoid **overdosing** on.

There are certain vitamins that pass **straight through** us in our urine (water soluble) but some do not (fat soluble).

It is possible to overdose on **fat soluble** vitamins namely vitamins A D E and K)

Take the recommended allowances, or in some cases a little more, but avoid "**megadosing**" in any extreme amounts.

I personally dose my Vitamin D3 quite high, due to living in an environment that lacks **sunlight**. In a later section there will be a Optimal Diet Section which will detail my ***supplement choices.***

Side effects of too many vitamins and minerals:

Vitamin A: Liver toxicity, hair and skin changes.

Vitamin B: Ataxia

Vitamin C: Gastric upset

Vitamin D: Soft tissue calcification

Vitamin E: Possible anti-platelet effects

Iron: Constipation

Zinc: Immunosuppression

Selenium: Brittle hair and nails.

Vitamins are great to take. We should try to get **natural sources** as much as we can too. For example, vitamin C in supplement form, is nearly always in the form of an acid called ascorbic acid.

But in nature, it rarely appears in this form and is usually accompanied by extra substances such as **rutin** which increases its effectiveness, which we do not see in the supplement form.

This is why doctors recommend that we eat a **balanced** diet and a **variety** of fruits and vegetables, to make sure we get everything.

A vitamin tablet can boost your health, but it cannot be as worthwhile for you if you always take it to **replace** natural fruits and vegetables.

RDA (Recommended Daily Allowance)

This is the absolute ***minimum*** amount of vitamins and minerals required. It does not guarantee good health but simply survival. This is a very low figure!

Most people would benefit from exceeding their vitamin and mineral RDA within reason and do well to follow advice such as:

- *5 portions fruit and veg per day.*
- *2L water per day.*
- *2000mg cod liver oil.*
- *Higher amounts of Vitamin D3 if living in a country with no sunshine.*

Remember, we do not need to megadose and take extreme amounts of vitamins, as that would be ***dangerous***.

But, when a tablet states that it contains 100% of your RDA, 100% of a small number is still a small number. It is simply doing the bare minimum to keep you alive.

It is ok to take an extra tablet here and there, and in my diet programme I do "just a bit more than the RDA," but, not enough to be dangerous.

In the vitamins stack section, I will show you the amounts that I take.

Food Labels

Always go by the **food labels** when looking at the calorie amounts and the content of a food.

Remember that a company can put things such as **"low calorie" "light" "reduced"** and the government allows them to say this as long as it has a **lesser** amount than the original.

There is no set percentage set for this lesser amount. A product could have 1 calorie less or have 1% less sugar in the product, and it could be marketed legally as "**low calorie**" or "**light.**"

A company can make a very **slight 1% decrease** and sell pretty much the same product as "reduced calorie" or "low calorie" or even "high protein" and not actually change the product much at all.

Half of the high protein stuff is **not actually** high protein. Therefore go by what you see on the **number** of grams of protein on the back, not just the words on the front of the product.

Compare the protein numbers you see on the back to the other similar items in the supermarket and see before you make a choice.

For example, I can expect to get 30 grams nowadays out of a protein shake milk drink.

But some milk drinks are marketed as high protein for less than half of that. I can expect to get 20 - 25 grams out of a sandwich if it is truly high protein.

I can expect to get 20 - 40 grams of protein out of a yoghurt depending on it's size if it is **truly** high protein.

Sugar

The general rule behind sugar is to **reduce** it as much as you can. Sugar contains energy (4kcals/g) but has zero nutrition associated with it.

The constant consumption of sugar will drain the body of micronutrients possibly leading to several conditions. Again the natural sugars in fruits are ok, but try to **avoid** high sugar foods.

Really remain **disciplined** when trying to lose weight, as too much sugar

spikes a chemical called insulin within your body. This can lead to you **craving** more food very fast.

A lot of people wonder why some days they seem to feel hungry all day and others they don't. They don't realise that sugar is **addictive.**

Insulin does benefit muscle gain, but better serves you when kept at stable levels through healthy, **slow release** carbohydrates that are more natural for your body and not **loaded** with sugar.

When you **spike your** insulin with high sugar foods, this leads to it rising really fast and coming down really fast. When the insulin comes down too fast, it leads to a tired feeling within us and a craving for more food.

Most people never come to this conclusion as they cannot really explain what is going on with their bodies.

They don't pay attention to the food they eat, they just think they randomly have days where they binge food and get really hungry.

Have you ever noticed when you are trying to cut weight, if you were to have a really sugary breakfast, like chocolate cereal mixed with a sugary yoghurt, it would likely trigger you to get hungry again very fast?

It can start a **cycle** very early on in your day of feeling really hungry and binging food.

If you never noticed this, pay attention to how you feel the next time you have a bowl of sugar loaded cereal and a bunch of sugary fruit juice in the morning.

By lunch or maybe even in the next hour you will likely be hungry again.

In our society we have been raised to believe it is the normal thing to have sugary cereal, white bread and jam, or honey waffles and pancakes for breakfast. These are the same **fast release** carbohydrates that will spike your insulin and leave you with **cravings**.

Low Sugar Breakfast Alternatives (Breakfast's To Start Your Day Correct)

I am going to give you some **healthy** alternatives to common breakfasts. These will give you energy and focus, instead of the common food crash before midday.

Here are some alternative breakfasts:

Toast

Instead of white bread, honey and jam, why not have brown bread, eggs, cottage cheese and avocado (avocado toast.) This will at least balance out some protein, and healthy fats into your system. The trick is to have one bit of bread, don't go too heavy on

carbs for breakfast, or you will get a tired feeling.

Once we cook the eggs, we think that we might as well have 3 or 4 seeing as we are already cooking and dirtying our pans, but 1 or 2 is usually enough with one bit of bread and some avocado.

Cereals

Instead of sugary cereal, why not have a **slow release** carb like oats. Don't use flavoured oats or instant porridge style as they have lots of **added sugar**.

Just use plain oats, with some blueberries for **brain power**, some

banana, some protein yoghurt, milk, chia seeds and a tiny bit of a high protein cereal or granola for your cereal fix.
You still get the feeling of pouring milk into a bowl, but it is healthier.

The **protein** in the protein yoghurt and the **fiber** from the chia seeds and oats will make you feel full and digest the sugar **slower**.

In fact, oats and chia seeds combine together with the two sources of fibre, **soluble** and **insoluble** and these two types combined provide a thickening effect in your stomach to help you with digestion, and help you feel full for longer.

Fruit Juices

Instead of drinking **large** glasses of orange juice with your breakfast, just have a small glass or better yet eat an actual orange.

This is because juicing removes the fibre that is present in the fruit that slows the absorption of sugar. Whilst drinking pure juice, you are drinking the amount of sugar present in 2 - 3 oranges and it is hitting your bloodstream almost **instantly**.

You could have a smaller glass or substitute for fruit, and drink plenty of water instead.

Yoghurt

If you are going to have a yoghurt, try and buy one of the high protein skyr yoghurts available nowadays in every super market. These are full of about 40 grams of protein.

Throw in a few blueberries and a banana and some chia seeds. Protein essentially slows digestion and helps the sugar not to spike you, keeps you feeling full, and chia seeds are fibre and they do the same thing.

Cheese and Crackers

Instead of this common meal, you can go for some **smoked salmon**, low fat cheese, and low fat rice cakes instead. Crackers tend to be higher calorie and can contain more sugar depending on the brand.

Fried Eggs

As an alternative to fried eggs, you could do a vegetable omelette. You can use spinach and mushrooms which you fry first, and then finally add the eggs.

Eggs can also be good with a **small** spoonful of rice.

Pancakes

Nowadays, there are brands of low carb, protein pancakes and waffles. I eat these and stay fully focused with no crash feeling.

It depends where you are in the world, but protein pancakes or waffles can be found with around 200 calories per serving and very **little** sugar.

If you have these breakfasts occasionally, and combine them with the **zero calorie** chocolate sauces that are also available nowadays, you can really enjoy the feeling of a classic sugary breakfast, without it actually being all that bad.

Full American / English / Mediterranean Breakfasts

This breakfast is often regarded as unhealthy, but with a few tweaks it has the potential to be a very balanced meal.

As you may have noticed in this chapter, breakfasts with a balance of protein, healthy fats, and slow release carbohydrates tend to be considered healthier.

They do the job of keeping you full, giving you energy throughout the day, and not spiking insulin sending you into a hunger spiral.

Full breakfasts can actually meet this criteria as they have a balance of

protein fat and fiber. In your breakfast:

Keep the mushrooms and the tomatoes. (these are fibrous vegetables that slow digestion.)

Switch the bread on the toast to sourdough toast. (Sourdough is more of a slow release carb than white bread)

Get rid of the hash browns or the fried potatoes. Mashed potato and potatoes in general have a high starch level which spikes insulin.

Keep eggs, meat and avocado. (protein and healthy fats)

Go for lean cuts of bacon and sausages look for pure meat sausages or high meat sausages. The less processed the better.

Look for **reduced** salt and sugar versions of baked beans. If you need more flavour to make up for the lack of sugar and salt, go for some **cheese** on top over extra sugar.

Tomato sauce is made up of about 35% pure sugar usually so, go easy on it.

If you make those changes to your full breakfast, you can produce a healthier version that works for your body to give it energy throughout the day, instead of putting yourself in a food coma!

Macros

When you hear the term **macros** in fitness. Don't get put off by the scientific talk. All it is, is your proteins, carbs and fats and the rough percentage of how you **balance** those daily.

Micros are simply just your vitamins and minerals like calcium in milk, or vitamin D. That's all there is to it on a basic level.

The main macro people focus on in fitness is **protein** and getting a certain amount of it.

There are some lifters that take things further and perfectly write out the percentages of proteins, carbs and fats they will eat daily, but I would say for 95% of lifters, this is **overcomplicating** things.

I would suggest most lifters to just focus on a protein intake of **1gram per pound of body weight**, and a generally clean diet of healthy foods.

As long as you hit your protein intake, the balance of carbs and fats does not matter as much for most non competitive lifters, and depends more on your body and what works for it.

For example one lifter would choose to go 30% protein, 35% carbs, and 35% fat. This is a **moderate** approach that gives you all your needs.

Another lifter may go 30% protein, 40% carbs and 30% fat. This gives slightly more **carbohydrates** to use as energy.

At this stage the difference is minor as long as protein remains above 30%.

There are opinions stating that carbohydrates give you more energy for a workout, but fats are also beneficial as they make you feel more full.

Some people find carbs more addictive. Some people find fats more addictive. Some people's body tolerates more of one of the other.

And in all honesty, some people just prefer to eat more carbs or fats, and

some wish to avoid them to make their diet easier.

Whatever ratio allows you to hit your **protein** target first and foremost and actually stick to your calories is the best.

You can experiment with your ratio if you wish and adjust based on the foods you like to eat, but the important part is your **protein** target.

When you look at any food label, you will see the three macros. Carbs, fats, proteins.

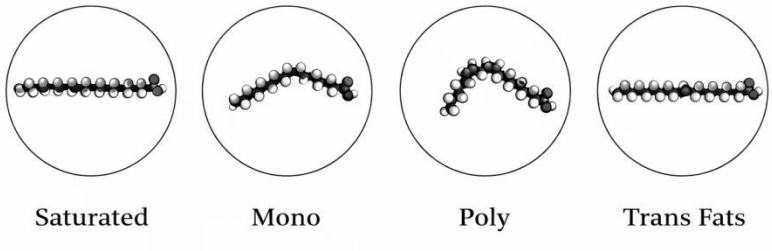
Food labels also have salt, sugar, and fiber on the label. These are not macros, but they are nice to know the amounts of to make healthy decisions.

Let's go through each of the macros so you can learn how to be **healthier** with each.

Fats

Fats are important for building up your hormones, specifically testosterone, which is responsible for a lot of muscle gain. There are 4 types of fats.

THE 4 TYPES OF FATS



Polyunsaturated Fats are your:
Omega 3s
Cod livers Oil
Omega 6s

They are healthy for your brain and keep you sharp.

Healthy Tips For Poly Fats:

Go for **1:1 ratios** or **1:2 ratios** of omega 3 to omega 6 in your supplements. These are ideal.

Some supplements have ratios that do not match these ideal ratios. I find Cod Liver Oil is the best for me because it achieves these ratios very well.

If you have a bit more money to spend, **cold pressed, unprocessed** cod liver oil is better for you.

Definitely ***do not cook*** with poly fat oils, they convert to unhealthy trans fats.

Replace your flaxseed oils, fish oils, and sunflower oils, there are better options.

Mono Unsaturated Fats

These are ***healthy*** fats. They are found in:

- Avacados
- Nuts
- Olive Oil
- Beef
- Seeds

Healthy Tips For Monounsaturated Fats:

To avoid turning your good, monounsaturated fats into less healthy trans fats (discussed later) do not overheat olive oil or nut oil when cooking.

You can tell when you have **overheated** an oil when it begins to **smoke**.

For cooking, choose oils that have a high “smoke point”. **Olive oil**, for example, has a smoke point of around 200 degrees centigrade compared to flaxseed oil that will smoke at around 100 degrees centigrade.

Cooking with oil correctly will help you not to convert the oil to trans fats, which will allow you to be more healthy.

Keep your mono and polyunsaturated oils in **dark glass air-tight containers**.

Buy **extra-virgin cold-pressed** oils.

Consider using natural **butter** instead of margarine as many margarine type spreads contain hydrogenated vegetable oils which are not as healthy.

Trans Fats

Trans fats block healthy fats from entering cells. It is best to avoid these.

Trans fats are contained in:

- Most Margarines
- Most Vegetable Oil Spreads
- Biscuits
- Cakes
- Ice Cream
- Take-Away Foods
- Pastries

- Pies
- Doughnuts
- Pre-Prepared Foods

Overconsumption of trans fats is strongly linked to immune system dysfunction, bone and tendon weakness, sterility, coronary heart disease, **high cholesterol** and triglyceride levels, inability to lactate, learning difficulties and low birth weight babies.

People are scared to consume fats, but it's not that consuming fats will automatically ***make us fat.***

Healthy fats are good for us, and can actually help us get the body of our dreams.

This is because fats help us to produce hormones which let us build muscle, and loose weight faster, but it is the ***unhealthy fats*** that contribute to us becoming unhealthy and large.

Saturated Fats

Saturated fats are often seen as the bad type of fats. But our bodies do need them. Saturated fats are seen as bad because they have a tendency to cause fat storage in our body when **combined** with carbohydrates. And what foods have both saturated fats and carbohydrates in large amounts?

- Burgers
- Pizza
- Chocolate

- Cakes
- Ice Cream
- Pastries
- Fried Foods

Incidentally, these are all the foods people consider the most unhealthy.

They are sugar filled, carbohydrate filled, and saturated fat filled, creating just about the perfect combination for your body to store fat.

It is better to take your **saturated** fats in the form of:

- *Grass Fed Butter*
- *Eggs*
- *Milk*
- *Meat*

These are healthy options that aren't as able to convert into fat as much when paired with other healthy foods.

To ***cut down*** on fat:

Choose lean cuts of meat and go for leaner mince.
Cut the fat off of meat and the skin off of chicken.
Try to grill meat and fish instead of frying.
Have a boiled or poached egg instead of fried.
If you eat more than 90g of red or processed meat per day, try to cut down to no more than 70g per day.

Avoid processed meats. The term processed meat includes sausages, bacon, cured meats and reformed meat products.

Cutting down on saturated fat will lessen the amount of calories consumed, lowering the chances of being in a calorie surplus.

Aim to keep saturated fats as 10% of your daily calories.

Cholesterol

There are two types of cholesterol. ***HDL*** (the good type) and ***LDL*** (the bad type.)

It is important to have ***cholesterol***, because during at night as we sleep, cholesterol helps to produce our hormones such as testosterone.

But, the bad type ***(LDL)*** can clog our body systems, affecting our longevity.

Things like eggs, avocados, nuts, oats and exercise actually boost the ***HDL*** (good cholesterol.)

Things like fried foods, fast foods, pastries, and desserts, they raise the ***LDL*** (bad cholesterol).

Are we noticing a trend here? The foods we usually consider as unhealthy, are often unhealthy in a large number of ways. Not just one.

As we have identified, the same group of foods seem to negatively affect ***cholesterol, hormones, fat levels,*** and ***health levels.***

Those bad foods will wreck your hormones, skin, energy levels and physique, as they get you fat and cause estrogen to rise. This is loosing

you muscle, and softening your mind and spirit.

Of course your ***mood*** and thirst to conquer life and achieve your best will be affected when your hormones are not working optimally.

This is something you can genuinely feel. The foods that we often consider as "healthy" that the "health crazy" people eat, are actually eaten for a **reason**.

They contain benefits on many different levels that we wouldn't think of when we are not educated on the matter.

There is one thing I would like you to take from this section on fats and this chapter in general.

If remembering 4 types of fats and the scientific names is too much for you, it is ok to take things slow and start simple.

Even personal trainers forget the scientific names and the **finer details** of nutrition sometimes.

Learning nutrition can be done in **stages**, I would suggest you take things slow, and at the minimum just practice the next few months consulting our lists of foods that are generally healthy and unhealthy.

If you spend a few months sticking to our guidelines, they will naturally stay with you.

At the beginner level, spend your first few months learning to read your

food labels and follow our healthy shopping lists.

Learn slowly, and build up your life around healthy food, and hitting your protein targets.

Whenever you forget or need notes as to why you don't eat a certain food, you can consult these chapters to remind yourself and bring yourself confidence that you are making the right choices.

Having a general idea and **list** of foods that are healthy and unhealthy, is more important than remembering the scientific names and the exact biology!

When you reach an intermediate level, you will generally know where you

stand with most foods in the supermarket, you won't just be following our list blindly, you will actually know through research why each food is good and bad. Your food shop will be a little more on autopilot.

Once you reach an advanced level, you can focus on the scientific names, and things like that, there will only be a few rare types of food that you do not know about. Healthy eating will be very familiar to you.

Carbs

Carbohydrates are the body's primary and most easily available source of energy. If fats are responsible for our hormones, and proteins are

responsible for building muscle, carbohydrates are responsible for keeping our **energy** up when we are working out.

Carbohydrates are **fuel**. And we use this fuel for long, intense workouts. Whilst carbs don't directly produce muscle, they allow us the energy to complete the long, intense workouts required to grow our bodies.

Carbohydrates once ingested, turn into glucose, which circulates in the bloodstream and fuels muscular contractions. Glycogen is also stored in the muscles and the liver for future use.

Adequate supplies of carbohydrates are essential for the serious athlete for a number of reasons. They

balance our insulin and leptin hormones which can help us build muscle.

They are mostly responsible for anaerobic performance(intense short burst sports.)

Some people in the fitness community cut out carbs. Without carbs, you will go into a state called **ketosis**.

This state can actually be really effective for losing weight, as your body switches from using carbohydrates as energy to burning fat for energy.

However, you have to stay strictly consistent with not eating carbs, as your body goes through a period

feeling really weak as it switches energy sources from carbs to fats.

This process requires a few weeks to adapt to. Some body builders have built insane bodies on keto (no carb diets), but it requires an extremely strict mindset shift, a period of getting used to, and many serious athletes would not consider cutting carbs due to the negative effects on high intensity performance.

This diet would not suit the bodies or minds of everyone, and different people report different results with keto. I would imagine those whose bodies react poorly to carbs could benefit from it greatly.

As long as protein targets and calorie targets are hit, one can build a great

body on this diet. Long term effects are still uncertain and note that it cuts out a major food group. I have seen some very in shape people following the keto diets.

However, it is very rare to see high level athletes cut out carbs, they simply have been proven in studies to allow better performance at high intensity.

Without carbs an athlete's ***performance*** would suffer in intense bursts of exercise, and strength lifts would likely drop compared to being on a diet of adequate carbs.

If your body is naturally growing in great shape with the use of carbohydrates then most will choose

to use carbohydrates as a tool to continue growing.

Carbs are especially useful for sports involving:

- HIIT
- Sprint intervals
- Team sports
- CrossFit
- Bodybuilding volume training
- Most Olympic sports
- Boxing

For this reason, you mostly do not see examples or studies of high level athletes claiming to use limited diets such as carnivore diets, or keto diets in olympic sports, because of the drop

off in performance when there are no carbs.

As an athlete carbs are considered vital. It is hard to lift heavy, to do high volume or long intense sessions, or do things like HIIT effectively without them.

Fast and Slow Release Carbs

Carbohydrates enter the body at different speeds, measured by the **glycemic index (GI)**.

High-GI foods are processed quickly and spike blood sugar, while low-GI foods release energy slowly and keep you full.

These terms replace “simple” and “complex” carbs, but mean much the same thing.

Fast and slow release carbohydrates are important to differentiate between because they can affect your body in different ways.

Fast Release Carbs (High GI)

- Examples: sticky restaurant rice, sugary cereals, white bread
- Effect: spikes blood sugar, triggers cravings, gives short bursts of energy
- Use: best in **small amounts** around workouts for a quick energy boost

Slow Release Carbs (Low GI)

- Examples: brown rice, rolled oats, sweet potato, whole grain bread
- Effect: steady energy, keeps you full, helps concentration
- Use: ideal for **daily meals** to avoid cravings and crashes

Earlier on in the nutrition chapter, I wrote a section on sugar.

In that section, I explained that high sugar foods ***spike*** our blood sugar very rapidly, which can lead to cravings of more food, and a loss of concentration in a "crash" when the

blood sugar spike drops back down too fast.

Foods that are ***high*** on the glycemic index (fast release carbohydrates) are usually prime examples of foods that spike your blood sugar.

Fast release carbs can be great in small amounts, especially for a pre or post workout snack. This is because they give you a great energy boost.

But for the majority of our everyday meals, it is best to stick to slow release carbs.

This is so we stay **concentrated** throughout the day, and do not trigger our hunger response and cravings for more food.

To compare the two terms:

Type Of Carb	Effect	Fullness	Energy Release
High Glycemic	Spikes Blood Sugar Fast	Doesn't Make You As Full	Quick Release Of Energy
Low Glycemic	No Spike	You Feel Full	Steady Release Of Energy

When we are armed with this knowledge, we can make ***substitutions*** to our diets, to ensure we are eating in a way that brings the best out of our bodies and minds.

Here are a few substitutions that are widely considered as **healthy**, that you can make today to avoid overconsumption of higher sugar, fast release carbohydrates:

Switching refined **white breads** to **brown and whole breads.**

Switching **white potato's** to **red or sweet potato's**

Switching **jasmine rice** and **white rice** to **brown rice**

Switching **white pasta** to **brown pasta**

Switching **instant honey flavored microwave oats** to **plain rolled oats**

Switching **watermelon** to **berries, apples or bananas**

Switching **sugary cereals** to **rolled oats**

Switching **high-sugar tomato sauce** to **low-sugar tomato sauce**

Switching **biscuits** to **apples** (high fiber and filling)

By making these swaps, you keep energy steady, reduce cravings, and support both ***mental focus and physical performance***.

I don't only want to give you the swaps, but now I want to explain to you ***why*** they are made.

This is so you understand the why behind your choices.

Bread and pasta are made from **starch**, which is naturally a **slow-release carbohydrate**.

But **white bread** and **white pasta** are made from refined flour, which makes it act like a **fast-release carbohydrate** instead.

When made from **refined flour**, the starch **acts more like a fast-release carb**, causing blood sugar to **spike**, rather than providing steady energy.

A court in Ireland ruled that the bread in the Subway restaurant chains is more like **cake** due to the sugar levels (refined carbohydrates.)

What you should take from this is just because you are eating a sandwich

marketed as healthy, it doesn't make it healthy.

Try to switch to **brown wholegrain breads** and make your own sandwiches filled with healthy organic ingredients.

Foods such as pasta and bread, are defined as **processed** food because they have been changed from their natural wheat form.

When choosing more natural carbohydrates opt for foods such as rice or potatoes as the carb source on your plate.

To avoid that "carb crash" that makes you tired at work at around mid day, avoid bagels, muesli, confectionery like doughnuts, protein chocolate

bars, refined sugars like sugary fizzy drinks.

These sugary items can make you crash very quick!

Whilst on paper an apple could have 15 grams of sugar, it contains natural sugars packaged with fiber, which prevents a rapid surge in blood sugar.

A pack of Maryland cookies could have 15 grams of sugar, but it is all added refined sugar.

This refined sugar enters your bloodstream very fast, creating a higher insulin spike.

An apple combined with natural porridge can be a good slow release

carbohydrate option instead of sugary cereals.

Replace Maryland cookies and other such biscuits with fresh apples as much as you can. Apples are a great snack in place of processed sugary foods.

Again, some refined carbohydrates can be good for a quick boost before a workout, such as peanut butter on rice cakes with some honey, or after a workout to recover.

But, to get a focused day's work done, you can opt for a majority of **slow-release carbs** that will keep you feeling full, charged and full of energy for long periods of time, without any insulin spikes causing cravings or loss of concentration.

Pre-Exercise Carbohydrate

Pre-exercise carbohydrates ensure that blood glucose levels and muscle glycogen stores are maximised. Starting a workout with low carbohydrate levels can impair performance intensity and duration, and lead to ***hypoglycemia.***

Around two hours or so prior to exercise, it is considered optimal to consume carbs, so that they are fully digested, and blood glucose/muscle glycogen levels are optimised by the time the workout is due to begin.

Exercising on a stomach full of food is at best **uncomfortable** and at worst can cause severe **cramps** and stomach

upset and therefore should be avoided.

The actual length of time an exerciser can eat before activity varies from person to person, but ***90 to 120*** minutes is about right for most people.

Closer to the start of the workout, a higher glycaemic (fast-acting) carbohydrate is believed to be more beneficial, and as digestion can be impeded by exercise, a drink can be a better choice than food.

Example Pre Workout Snacks -

Apple (slow acting) with **raspberry protein yoghurt** (slow acting) 2 hours before or 1h 30 mins before exercise.

Apple and **peanut butter** - slowly digesting, good to eat about an hour before exercise
A Banana (fast acting) is good to take about half an hour before workout.

If you want fast energy, pair **yoghurt** with:

- a banana
- honey
- oats

Rice cakes, peanut butter and **chopped banana** - 45 minutes before workout. Spread the peanut butter on top of the rice cake and put 3 circular slices of banana on the top of each cake.

Carb Gels - Consuming carbs during exercise is acceptable if:

- The session is longer than one hour
- If the match or race is longer than 90-minutes

If a ***pre-exercise carbohydrate meal*** is not possible e.g. early morning training, the consumption of carbohydrates during prolonged exercise is not ideal, as ingesting carbs during exercise can inhibit fat loss.

People tend to use **carb gels** or snacks on marathons or long sessions of exercise over an hour. But they accept that their target is performance in this case and not fat loss.

Eating after a workout does not cancel fat burn, so this is safe to do.

However, the only time eating stops fat burn briefly is ***during*** the workout, due to insulin, as your body burns whatever energy is most recently and readily available, in this case it is the sugar from a sports drink you just drank or the food you just ate.

This leads to your body burning the carbohydrates in these foods for energy instead of fat.

Therefore, eating mid workout and drinking anything more than water is not as great for burning fat.

If you must eat during a workout, try and go for **carb gels**, **carb gummies,**

bananas or **rice cakes**. This is for the purpose of digestion.

If you are going to be doing intense cardio then note this:

Eating things like peanut bars(sit in the stomach) cereal bars (high in fiber) and apples(high in fiber and fructose) within 10 minutes of a workout, or during, often cause an upset stomach during working out intensely or on long runs, but this is not commonly known!

Sports Drinks

Do you really need a sports drink? Many sports drinks contain artificial flavours, colours, sweeteners and a

host of other chemicals that have no place in a beverage which is designed to be healthy.

If you are exercising for 60 minutes or less, are exercising for weight loss and have eaten properly in the hours leading up to your workout, it is suggested that plain water is more suited to your purposes.

This is because any calories or carbs consumed during exercise can affect your **fat loss**. And sports drinks can contain both calories and sugars.

If, on the other hand, you have not eaten properly before training, are going to be working for 60 minutes or more and are not trying to burn fat during your workout, a sports drink is an acceptable way to stay hydrated.

If your goal is fat loss:

Avoid calories and sports drinks with calories during workouts, because your body will use them instead of fat.

If your goal is performance or long-duration training:

Fueling can improve **endurance** and **power**. If you are doing marathons, or high intensity sessions longer than an hour, where you didn't have breakfast.

If you would prefer not to use commercial sports drinks, you can easily make your own isotonic sports drink by following these recipes from the Paralympic Association:

Dissolve 60g of glucose powder into a litre of water and add one-fifth of a teaspoon of natural unprocessed salt.

Mix 500ml of unsweetened natural fruit juice with 500ml of water and add one-fifth of a teaspoon of natural unprocessed salt.

Electrolyte Drinks

Who needs electrolyte drinks? If you are an athlete training longer than an hour, training multiple intense sessions, or training in a hot country where you will sweat a lot, then you can add electrolytes.

In this case, even though the government tells you that you should avoid going beyond 6grams of salt per

day as much as possible, it is acceptable in this case to **add salts** to your water as you will sweat out way more than 6 grams of salt as an athlete in hot conditions.

A good brand I've found is Royal - D sachets in Thailand. It tastes like orange and the kickboxers over there drink that all the time to perform well in the heat.

I drank it and I could go for hours in the heat. These powders can be expensive in other corners of the world. If you don't like the commercial drinks, you can make a homemade version.

A quick and affordable way to add electrolytes to a drink is to add a

pinch of table salt, a squeeze of lemon juice, to some water.

Add some coconut water in as well and you will have your own electrolyte drink.

Home Made Electrolyte Drink Recipe

-

- 400ml Coconut Water
- 200ml Orange Juice
- 4 tbsp Lemon Juice
- ½ tsp Sea Salt
- 3-4 tbsp Honey or Maple Syrup
- Fill the rest with Water (approx. 300-350ml)

If you are one of those people who sometimes feels ***"confused"*** in the hot weather, and you feel like your brain is moving slow in the heat, this drink combined with a cold shower can alleviate those effects. It is a cool life hack to know!

Post-Exercise Food

What you eat over the course of the day matters far more than the exact meal after your workout.

If you're on a calorie-controlled diet and not hungry immediately after training, you don't need to **force** a post-workout meal.

Simply stick to the healthy dinner or meal you were already planning—your body will still recover, refuel, and progress as long as your total daily nutrition supports your goals.

Protein

Protein is responsible for muscle growth and is super important. I can tell you that I trained for a very long time, and did not see results until I took my protein intake seriously.

How To Set Your Protein Target

You want to work out what your body weight is in pounds (lbs). That is how many grams of protein you need to try and consume daily.

If you weigh **140lbs**, then you need to try and consume **140 grams** of protein.

Not all protein is created equal

1g per pound of body weight is an important target to hit, however, an extra thing to consider is that different foods have different percentages of ***usable*** proteins.

This is why it can be useful to select our food carefully. I noticed a lot of people that are really strong, seemed to eat a larger than normal amounts of eggs.

These athletes disregarded the notion that eggs will clog up your arteries, they understood eggs were a source of healthy fats. Some of them did go overboard, and had more eggs per day than I would recommend to you.

But the truth is they all got into extreme shape. When you check the charts of the most absorbable proteins, what do you know, eggs contain the highest percentage of absorbable protein (apart from whey protein.)

Whey protein is another food product that people tend to avoid without good reason, you often hear people say things like: *"It sets like cement in your stomach! It is like eating cement."*

I get it, some of those protein shakes are full of sugar, but the science doesn't lie.

Whey isolate is the most highly absorbable protein, sitting at a higher percentage than even eggs.

Eggs measured in at a score of "100% available protein" when this information was first studied, and then recently, ***whey isolate*** came along and reached 104%.

Whey has the ability to allow your body to use complete proteins ***more*** than the highest quality organic proteins.

You can get sugar free versions of whey and versions that work for any ***dietary requirements.***

For example, if you are **lactose intolerant,** you don't need to use **whey concentrate** which is lactose based.

You can use whey isolate. There are non sugared forms of whey if you are prone to acne, and vegan proteins as well.

I think people are quick to count out this product without exploring all

available products or really understanding it.

When people say whey forms like a cement inside of you, it is false. There is a form of whey called ***casein*** (which is also super bioavailable and gets a very high usable protein score) that forms a gel in your stomach.

But this gel is actually ***beneficial*** for making you feel full for longer.

When it comes to whey isolate, it is simply the opposite of a cement, it is a super digestible powder and your body digests it faster than nearly any other food.

It is lactose free, and the only reason it would give you a bad stomach is if

you relied only on shakes the whole day and not a balanced diet.

The **key rule** is to use protein shakes to boost a balanced diet instead of using shakes ***only***.

If you select a ***high quality*** protein shake that is correct for the job, and consume as part of a balanced diet, there are minimal downsides.

I don't think we should completely ignore protein shakes and the science points towards them being very useful.

If you use protein shakes for the purpose of keeping your protein high whilst keeping your calories low, they can be very useful.

Yes there are some “mass gainers” that are ***loaded with sugar***. Yes there are some protein shakes that may contain different products that may not agree with you and your skin, but nowadays the market is so large and diverse for these products, you can find a shake that suits your dietary needs.

If you are rich and can afford a chef to cook you high quality steaks all day, with the leanest cuts of beef, then you may be able to go without.

But I find these shakes a very low calorie, efficient way of hitting required protein targets with my clients.

What Is Protein?

Protein is what ***builds*** your muscle. Proteins are chains of amino acids that help you to form muscle. If you were to ask me how significant protein is? Well.

Let's put it this way:

I have lifted and trained for years, and only started to see worthwhile gains when I found out my protein targets and started to hit them.

If you do not take your protein intake seriously, you are adding 2 - 3 years to the time it takes to get your dream body, and you may never achieve

your dream body until you actually realise how important protein is.

You may never intake enough protein to grow to that *"amazing body"* level.

Don't make the mistake of underestimating this area of your training, or you will come back in 2 years time repeating the same cycle I have seen many people make.

They realise I was correct and say "I wish I had done things right from the start, I wish I didn't lose 2 years of training time being inefficient."

The truth is everyone seems to think they can just come in the gym, lift a

few weights, and be like Arnold Schwarzenegger in a year or so.

But in the real world, building muscle is a slow process, and it is limited by the protein that you consume.

You are not that superman or superwoman who is just going to grow no matter what they do. 9 out of 10 people I coach do not have that luck.

If you are hitting the gym, but you don't have enough protein, you have a deficiency that will stop you from growing. It is almost like a wasted session.

The only worse thing than a wasted session is a wasted year or two, from people who think they are going to

have “amazing genetics” and not take their diet seriously.

Then they realise after 2 years they still don’t look how they wanted, and think there is something wrong with them.

When really there was never anything wrong with them, they simply needed to understand the science and consume the protein needed to grow.

Make sure you get enough protein, and get your first few years right!

Remember, your target is ***simple:***

whether you are man or woman, young or elderly. It is 1gram of protein per pound of bodyweight.

For example: as a man weighing 70kg, (which is 156lbs) that would be 156grams of protein.

Sources of protein:

Nowadays, it is very easy to hit protein targets due to supermarkets adopting high protein foods. You should look on the back of the label to check the actual amount of protein in grams.

A lot of “high protein" labelled foods are not actually high protein. Always go by the numbers on the label.

Also know that some foods have more available protein than others. Your body can utilise a larger percentage of

protein from some foods more than others.

Remember how I said proteins are amino acids, and there are many different amino acids?

Your body needs **9 essential amino acids** from food.

- A **Complete protein** has all 9 essential amino acids in good amounts. Such as eggs, meat, dairy
- **Incomplete protein** = Missing or very low in one or more essential amino acids. Such as beans, rice, nuts (most plant proteins)

If a protein is missing essential amino acids, it cannot be used by your body

as well to create muscle as a complete protein chain of all 9 essential acids.

20 grams of protein from two different sources can have a slightly different efficiency whether they have all the amino acids relevant to complete the protein or not.

However incomplete sources such as rice which are missing lysine but high in methionine can be combined together with beans which are higher in lysine but lower in methionine to form complete amino acids.

Some examples of protein pairing can include:

Grains + Legumes
Nuts / Seeds + Legumes
Grains + Dairy

If you pair incomplete proteins together the protein availability becomes less of a problem, and **all of this is subtle**, but the **key takeaway** I want you to make from this section is:

Not all foods are created equal. No matter what dietary trends appear, or new processed foods get released onto the market, there are healthy, basic prime sources of protein that you can use.

I want you to look at this list so you can get a feel for some proteins that are shown as high availability protein foods, and get to building your diet around these foods.

These foods will always be great for building muscle.

Here is a list of high protein foods and a percentage system that was constructed to rate how well our bodies can absorb and use the protein from each type of food:

Food / Product	**Protein availability (%)**
Whey protein isolate	98%
Whole egg	97%
Milk	95%
Cottage cheese	95%
Greek yogurt	95%
Tuna	95%

Fish (general)	92%
Chicken	92%
Beef	92%
Pork	92%
Soy protein isolate	88%
Tofu	87%
Protein pasta	85%
Protein bread	85%
Pea protein	82%
Chickpeas	78%

Lentils (red/green)	74%
Peanuts	73%
Split peas	72%
Potatoes (white)	72%
Potatoes (sweet)	72%
Black beans	70%
Kidney beans	70%
Pinto beans	70%
Navy beans	70%
Rice	62%

Oats	60%
Wheat	50%

If you follow the rule of hitting 1 gram of protein per pound of body weight, you will do **way** better than the average person out there when it comes to building muscle.

However, if you want to take things even further, it is best practice to try and get 70 - 80% of your protein from higher quality sources per day. Any less and you may face the consequences of getting slightly less muscular.

As you can see, lean organic meats, free-range eggs, organic milk and raw nuts are all good sources of protein that will provide amino acids and other essential nutrients.

Other good sources of protein:

- Seitan (Wheat Gluten) - 75g protein per 100g (Vegan meat replacement)
- Spirinula

Not-so-good protein choices:

- Burgers
- Sausages
- Meat pies,

- UHT dairy
- Roasted nuts
- Non-organic pulses,
- Reformed meats such as luncheon meat and battery-farmed eggs

(Reformed and processed meats often contain as little as 6% actual meat, a figure allowable by law, and much of their weight consists of water, fillers such as wheat, sugar and bone meal.)

How To Pick A Good Protein Shake

There are some different forms of protein shakes. Most people find

whey isolate and **casein** protein to be the most absorbable forms of protein.

Casein is a longer release protein that works better to release protein overnight as you sleep, and whey isolate is an all around great protein shake.

A good reputable brand of protein shakes is **optimum nutrition** who have been making protein shakes across the world for years.

I will run you through the ins and outs of the different types of protein shakes.

Whey Protein Isolate

Whey protein isolate or WPI for short is the purest form of whey protein currently available and by weight contains between **90 to 95%** protein.

WPI contains **very little or no lactose** which makes it ideal for individuals who suffer from lactose intolerance.

WPI contains only trace amounts of carbohydrates and fats which makes it ideally suited for those looking to gain lean mass or lose fat.

The purity of WPI can mean it is slightly **more expensive** than other types of whey, but as you get a purer

and more concentrated product, there is a benefit to this elevated cost.

Of all the whey protein forms, WPI is the **fastest and most easily digestible** which makes it especially well-suited for post-exercise consumption.

I usually suggest whey isolate as the number one form of protein to most of my clients who do not require **specialised** diets.

I have found WPI to work with a wide range of clients as it is free from gluten, there are halal options, and it is very popular around the world.

Certain brands can worsen acne in those that are prone to it, so you have

got to pick the right brands. Try and go for **low sugar** brands.

Whey Protein Concentrate

Whey protein concentrate, WPC for short, is less pure than WPI and provides anywhere between 25 to 85% protein by weight, depending on the quality of the product in question.

Lower-grade WPC is often used in protein bars and also as an added ingredient in more common foods such as soups, crackers and cereals.

WPC contains more carbohydrates in the form of **lactose**, along with slightly more fat, minerals and water when compared to WPI.

This **lower purity** is usually reflected in the price. If you use WPC, seek out products that provide around 80% protein by weight as these are the most useful for muscle growth and repair.

Hydrolized Whey

Protein is made up of chains of amino acids called polypeptides. The longer and more complex the polypeptide chain, the longer the protein will take to digest.

Sometimes, for example, between meals or late at night, a slow-digesting protein may be useful, but in the period immediately before and after exercise, a more fast-acting protein is better.

In **hydrolysed** whey protein, the long polypeptide chains have been broken down into shorter chains called oligopeptides which are rapidly digested and provide a very quick supply of amino acids to your muscles.

This rapid delivery of amino acids results in speedier recovery from strenuous exercise. Hydrolysed whey protein is more **expensive** than WPI and WPC and is best kept for immediate post-exercise.

Of all the forms of whey protein, hydrolysed whey is the least likely to cause **digestive upsets.**

Whey Protein Blends

While it is possible to buy products that contain either whey protein isolate, whey protein concentrate or hydrolysed whey protein, many products use a customized **blend** so that you can benefit from the unique properties of each type of whey.

Whey protein blends are usually good value for money and suitable for a wide variety of users and purposes, as well as being widely available.

Read the ingredients list so you know exactly what is in your whey protein blend and be aware that many products use a lot of whey protein concentrate as it is the cheapest form of whey.

When considering a whey protein product consumers should:

- Seek out cold-processed protein powders manufactured below 50 degrees C to avoid denaturing (**damaging** the protein and rendering it less digestible)
- Choose products with no added sugar, sweeteners or artificial flavours
- **Mix** whey protein with full-fat milk, organic peanut/almond butter or coconut oil to enhance protein metabolism
- Remember that whey protein shakes are a supplement to, and not a replacement for, **healthy food**

One last thing to remember is that protein consumption, **beyond what is actually needed,** will not automatically be converted to muscle but may actually become fat.

Fibre

For humans, although fibre does not contribute meaningful usable energy to your daily diet, it provides numerous important health benefits.

The RDA (recommended daily allowance) for fibre is around **30–35 grams** per day, ideally split between soluble and insoluble fibre.

If you are currently eating too little fibre and decide to increase it, do so **gradually**.

Going from a low-fibre diet to a high-fibre diet overnight is like trying to run a marathon on the first day you take up jogging.

Increase your intake slowly over several weeks to minimise digestive discomfort such as bloating and cramping.

To prevent common digestive problems, it is essential to eat fibre (found in fruit, vegetables and whole grains). Fiber is vital for the easy passage of food through the intestines.

Without sufficient fibre and water, we can become constipated and have less frequent and/or more difficult bowel movements, which puts an unnecessary strain on our digestive system.

If left unchecked this strain can develop into a condition called ‘diverticular disease’, where bulges occur in the walls of the large intestine, and bacteria builds up, resulting in abdominal pain.

To maintain the health of the digestive system, eat plenty of fresh fruit and vegetables, choose whole grains in preference to refined grains, drink plenty of water, take care with food hygiene and exercise regularly.

There are **two types** of fiber.

Type Of Fiber	Foods	Effect
Soluble Fiber	Oats, Lentils, Beans, Apples.	Adds Thick Gel Paste To Stomach, Making You Feel Full, Slows Digestion For A Settled Effect
Insoluble Fiber	Whole Grains, Brown Rice, Broccoli, Avocado, Chia Seeds	Adds Bulk To Stomach Making You Feel Full, Good For Digestion & Healthy Bowel Movements

Sources of fiber:

Source Of Fiber	Amount
Chia Seeds (1tbsp)	**5g**
Broccoli (1 cup)	**5g**
Avocados (1 medium)	**10g**
Beans (1 cup cooked)	**12-15g**
Lentils (1 cup cooked)	**15g**
SOME Cereals	**12g**
Bananas	**5g**
Whole Grains(1 cup brown rice)	**5g**

While getting enough fibre is important, supplementation is rarely the best approach.

Fibre supplements such as bran or psyllium husks provide fibre, but they lack the additional **nutritional** benefits found in whole foods — particularly vitamins, minerals, and protective plant compounds.

Relying too heavily on fibre **supplements** may even contribute to food deficiencies if they replace whole foods in the diet.

The best way to get enough fiber in your diet is to eat a wide variety of fruit, vegetables, grains and other natural food.

Refined foods such as white bread, white rice, white pasta and processed meals contain very little fibre so, wherever possible, search for foods in their most natural and unprocessed state.

Simply following the old advice of **eating an apple a day** is one way to make sure you are on your way to getting enough essential fibre in your diet.

Fiber Keeps You Full

Fibre is **low calorie & high volume**: To put this in perspective, an apple and a typical biscuit both contain around 60 calories.

Because much of the mass of the apple is made up from calorie-free fibre and water, compared to sugar and fat in the biscuit, the apple is bigger, far more filling and much more satisfying to eat.

Most of us can eat a few biscuits in a single serving but it's pretty unlikely you'll eat the same number of apples!

This is also the same for a breakfast of oats and chia seeds.

The oats are mostly soluble fiber and the chia seeds are insoluble fiber, so you get the effect of a gel paste thickening your stomach(from soluble fiber) as well as bulk added from the insoluble fiber.

Combining this with an apple, some protein yoghurt (protein keeps us full too) and the fact that oats are a slow release carbohydrate, we can create a power bowl for breakfast that is going to keep us full a lot longer than sugary cereal.

Fibre is one of the most powerful natural appetite regulators available. When you eat, stretch receptors in your stomach signal to your brain that you are full — but this message can take as long as **30 minutes** to be sent and received.

High-fibre foods increase gastric distension (stomach expansion), meaning you feel satisfied sooner and remain full for longer, and you get the "stop eating signal" sooner than usual.

A simple strategy I use: if you feel very hungry, eat your meal, then wait **20–30 minutes** before deciding to eat more.

Often, once digestion begins and those fullness signals reach your brain, the urge to keep eating subsides.

Dairy

When it comes to ***dairy***, you can make the following changes:

- Switch all your eggs if you can to organically farmed eggs which stress the chicken less

and produce an egg with more nutrients.

- Always go for **lower fat** and **lower sugar products** wherever possible. For example, why not try 1% fat milk which contains about half the fat of semi-skimmed milk without a noticeable change in taste or texture?

- You can also try reduced-fat cheese which is also widely available, babybel lights have around 5grams of protein at only 49 calories. Low fat cottage cheese and low fat greek yoghurts are used often in a fitness context.

- When buying dairy alternatives, go for unsweetened, calcium-fortified versions.

Exercise 1 - Survey To Improve Your Diet

This exercise will help you to **fix your diet with me** in 2 minutes.

Answer the questions below: Every **yes** is a 1 and every **no** is a 0. Count your marks. I filled in my example answers, so you can see my results and how I used them to change my diet.

- Do you add sugar to food or drinks almost every day? *No*
- Do you eat foods with added sugars almost every day? *No*
- Do you use large amounts of salt in your food? *No*
- Do you drink more than one cup of coffee on most days? *No*
- Do you have caffeinated drinks after 4 pm? *No*
- Do you smoke more than five cigarettes a day? *No*
- Do you take recreational drugs? *No*
- Do you drink more than 10 Oz (28g) of alcohol (1 glass of wine, 1 pint or 600ml of beer, or 1 measure of spirits) a day? *No*
- Do you eat fried food more than twice a week? *Yes*

- Do you eat processed 'fast food' more than twice a week? *No*
- Do you eat processed meats (such as sausages, ham or smoked salmon) more than twice a week? *No*
- Do you often eat foods containing additives and preservatives? *No*
- Do you eat chocolate, pastries or sweets more than twice a week? *No*
- Does less than a third of your diet consist of fruit and vegetables? *No*
- Do you drink less than ½ pint (300ml) of plain water each day? *No*

- Do you normally eat white rice, pasta, flour or bread rather than wholegrain? *No*
- Do you have less than a pint (approx.0.6litres) of milk or yoghurt a week? *No*
- Do you eat more than four slices of bread a day, on average? *No*
- Are there some foods you feel 'addicted' to? *Yes, Magnum ice cream*
- Do you eat oily fish less than twice a week and/or seeds less than daily? *No*

Total Score: _____*2*_____

- **0-4:** You are a health-conscious individual and the minor indiscretions are unlikely to affect your health. Provided you support your diet with the essential vitamins and minerals, together with the advice that you will learn throughout this course, you can look forward to a long and healthy life.

- **5-9:** Your diet is on the right track, but you should now try to be more aware of what you are eating. Rather than giving up bad habits all at once, set short term goals. Aim to have your score below 5 within three months.

- **10-14:** Your diet is not healthy and you will need to help yourself make some changes in order to be able to enjoy better health. Encourage yourself to take one step at a time.

You should aim to reduce your score down to 5 within six months. Start to motivate yourself with the healthy eating tips that you will find below.

You will find that some of your bad dietary habits will change for the better as you receive education and encourage yourself to do better. The bad habits that remain should be dealt with one at a time.

Make sure you remind yourself that sugar, coffee, pastries, sweets, chocolate, tobacco and alcohol are

all addictive. Your cravings for them will dramatically decrease or go away altogether after one month without them.

- **15-20:** There is no way you can continue to eat like this and remain in good **health**. You are consuming far too great a quantity of fat, refined foods and artificial stimulants.

  Encourage yourself to follow the healthy eating tips that you will find below. You need the support and **motivation** from yourself and others around you for a longer period of time to make gradual and permanent changes to your lifestyle.

You may feel worse for the first two weeks, but within a month you will begin to feel the **positive** effects of **healthy eating.**

My Results:

I got a score of 2 because I've been doing fitness for a long time. But if you get a big score, don't be **overwhelmed!**

In a way this is a **good thing** as it means you will be able to quickly improve and get that feeling of immense change, doing good for yourself. You have more to change than someone who got a lower score and that's great.

Your goal is now to turn 5 of these yeses above into no's within 3 months. Write them on your fridge as **written** and present goals.

In my results I noticed I had been consuming so many ice creams, and not only did I eat fried foods many times per week, I was using lots of oil.

The Plan I Made From My Results :

"I will eat less magnum ice creams as they trigger cravings. I will only limit myself to 1 per month. My

forfeit for consuming more will be that I owe my girlfriend £50.

I will try to oven cook a bit more instead of frying. I will use the low calorie sprayable oils when I fry my food, as I tend to pour too much oil when I use bottled oil.

I will encourage my girlfriend to buy protein pancakes from the fitness brands that I use instead of the high sugar supermarket ones, and avoid buying chocolate bars, or biscuits to dip in tea.

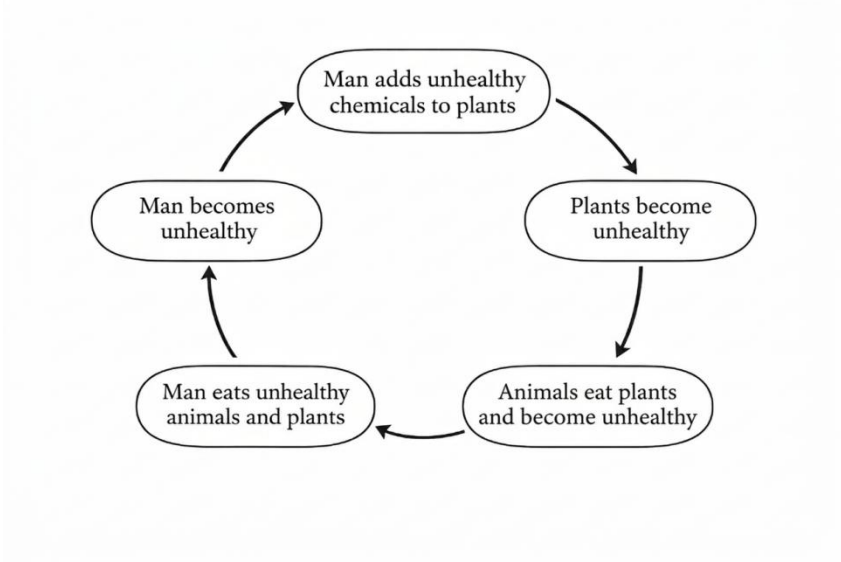
I will apply more chia seeds in my oats for breakfast for extra fiber.

I want to buy Yakult probiotics and stay consistent with them again.

I want to improve my snacking habits, with more mango, blueberry, oranges, apples, bananas to snack on.. Brazil nuts or pistachios will also be purchased..

I will use greens powders to get extra greens as my girlfriend doesn't like cooking with kale."

Eating Organic Foods



Nutritionally, many seemingly healthy foods are considerably less nutritionally dense than they were as little as 50 years ago. This is because of intensive farming methods, where there is use of artificial fertilizers,

pesticides, herbicides, fungicides, antibiotics and growth hormones.

Thankfully, there is an alternative:
Organic farming.

Organic food producers are subject to strict regulations that promote higher farming standards, resulting in food that is healthier.

Several studies have demonstrated that food grown organically contains far more essential nutrients than traditionally-farmed foods, but with none of the harmful artificial substances used in regular farming.

Organic food is **regulated** and must:

- Contain minimal additives

- Use no pesticides, fungicides or herbicides in the production
- Contain no genetically modified ingredients
- Involve no non-essential or routine antibiotic treatment on animals
- Ensure animal welfare is paramount

It is good to go organic, but don't let the food companies **rip you off!** Now that organic food is seen as healthy, some companies do sell some foods under the organic name that still **aren't really healthy.**

While organic fruit, meat, vegetables, nuts, seeds and grains are undoubtedly healthy; organic cookies, cakes, ice creams, sugary breakfast

cereals or processed meals are still **far from healthy** and should be consumed in moderation, if at all.

Exercise 2 - Creating A Food Diary

On the notes page on your phone, it is a very good use of your time to note the **foods you eat**, and how your body **reacts** to them.

You will start to notice very clear **patterns** about what you eat and how it affects you.

This lets you narrow down the foods that make you highly productive, which improves your life.

Create your **food diary.**

Construct it exactly like this:

Good Foods -

Hit & Miss Foods -

Bad Foods -

Have a look at my **example** food diary,
this is a **short** example & my real one
would be more detailed!

Good Foods -

Mango (puts me in a great mood)

Raspberry Protein Yoghurt (makes me full the whole day)
Apples (as long as they are not before intense running)

Hit & Miss Foods -

Eggs and tuna (good at night time, can sometimes make me sleepy at breakfast)
Tuna avocado sandwich (good but if I eat too much bread I get sleepy, have to control portion size)

Bad Foods -

Magnum ice cream (triggers cravings - I will eat 5 in a row)

Subway cookies (make me feel terrible)
Apples (30 minutes before intense running can cause stomach upset whilst running)

Shopping List To Help You Reach Your Goals

Once you go for your first healthy shop, you will find a lot of positivity come into your life and mood.

If you are fortunate enough to be able to fill your fridge, fill it with healthy foods.

Here is a list that can help you. Take responsibility for your own shopping and ensure that this list is somewhat followed.

Try to educate family members or partners to shop in this style too so that they bring healthy food around you.

Vitamins

Cold Pressed Butter Oil
Cold Pressed Omega 3
Zinc
Magnesium
Vitamin C
Whey Protein Powder
Creatine
Greens Powder (optional - adds more rare forms of greens to your diet)

BCAA (optional as most protien shakes contain them nowadays)

Sugars

Raw Honey
Brown Sugar
Dark Chocolate Lindt 80% Cocoa

Fruits

Apples
Bananas
Blackberries
Mango
Mandarin Segments (Vit C) OR Easy Peelers Oranges

Vegetables

Avocado

Kale
Lettuce
Broccoli
Tomato
Carrots
Bell Peppers
Cucumber

Carbs

Sweet Potatoes
Red Potatoes
Brown Rice
Brown Pasta
Brown Whole Grain Bread
Rice Cakes

Meat

Chicken Breast

Wild Alaskan Salmon Fillets
Tuna
Basa Fish or Cod

Protein

Eggs
Brazil Nuts / Pistachio Nuts
Grated Mozzarella / Cheddar (50% Less Fat)
Skyr Protein Yoghurts
Yakult Probiotics
Protein Shakes
Protein Granola Cereal + High Fibre Cereal
Protein Porridge
Protein Pancakes
Semi Skimmed Milk
Low Fat High Protein Greek Yoghurt
Cottage Cheese
PB Protein Peanut Butter(Amazon)

Oils

Olive Oil Cold Pressed Extra Virgin
Low Calorie Spray Olive Oil
KerryGold Organic Grass Fed Butter

Spices

Adobo Seasoning
Smoked Paprika
Paprika
Jerk Seasoning
Garlic Salt
Onion Granules
Black Pepper
Salt
Low Sugar Ketchup
Nandos Peri Sauce Medium
Tabasco Sauce

Healthy Meal Section

Here are some meals to help you. These meals not only make me feel alert but also in a good mood, and my brain feels productive on them.

They are great for athletes, and for keeping your hormones good. They are good for not making you lose your focus during the day when you need to **focus** on work.

If you cannot yet cook these meals, I want you to make an effort to start learning cooking.

Even if you are the type of person who has a chef or orders on uber eats all the time. There will come times in

your adult life where cooking healthy food can simply be a great asset.

You may be travelling around a lot. You may need to cook for a partner on a date night to show love.

That partner may be vegetarian, or likes to eat healthily, and if you have children or family members it can be really important to cook healthy for them.

If you can't throw together basic healthy fitness meals for yourself, your family, your partner or kids, I want you to start learning as it is simply a great life skill to have.

You will honestly find sometimes that you are able to cook better food than

ordering on Just Eat and you will have more control over your life.

As your coach I really want to encourage you to level up your ability to create healthy food for yourself and others.

Mood Boosting Power Breakfast Bowl

This is a great breakfast with slow release carbohydrates (oats) and 2 types of fiber to keep you full and avoid blood sugar spikes and that mid day crash feeling associated with high sugar breakfast cereals.

Healthy mood boosting fruits also help to make this meal a healthier alternative to sugary cereal.

Ingredients

Mango - Mango has B6 which boosts your mood
Banana - Banana has B6 and tryptophan
Blueberries - Vitamin C
Raspberries - Vitamin C
Rolled Oats (fiber type 1)
Chia seeds (fiber type 2)
Raspberry Protein Yoghurt - 20 grams protein
Semi Skimmed Milk

Protein Works Breakfast Pancakes & Oats

This brand of oats and pancakes combined with their zero calorie chocolate sauce has given me a lot of

breakfasts that are low calorie, high protein, and seem to be low sugar enough to not spike any cravings within me.

You mix the pancake mix with milk, or the oats with milk, and they are ready to go.

Simple Protein Yoghurt Breakfast

Ingredients

Raspberry 20gram Protein Yoghurt
Blueberries
Apple
Raspberries

Protein Cereals

Nowadays there are even protein cereals such as protein waffle mixes, protein hoops and protein granola that you can mix with a protein yoghurt. These are very affordable nowadays.

Salmon + Kale

Ingredients

2 Salmon Fillets
Serving Of Kale
2 Bell Peppers
Garlic Salt
Organic Grass Fed Butter

Cooking Instructions

Fry the salmon in organic grass fed butter, and add garlic salt to each side of the salmon. Cook the salmon until golden.

After this, fry some bell peppers in the same pan for a few minutes until they are soft and get those little brown blister marks. In the last 3 minutes add the kale, and stir them into the peppers.

Serve the salmon on top of the vegetables.

Salmon + Mashed Potatoes + Salad

Ingredients

2 Salmon Fillets
Ready Made Mash Potato Portion
Ready Made Salad
Garlic Salt
Organic Grass Fed Butter

Cooking Instructions

A very easy time efficient recipe. I buy some salmon, the cheap ready made mashed potato from the supermarket, and a ready made salad from the supermarket.

Both are cheap options, and I simply fry the salmon in organic grass fed butter and garlic salt.

After, I serve the salmon with the mashed potato with a little black pepper on the top, some cilantro for decoration, and the salad.

Tuna Salad

Ingredients

2 cans of tuna in spring water (drain the spring water)
1 Avocado
4 Cherry Tomatoes
A Bowlful Of Chopped Lettuce or a Pre Made Salad
Parmesan Cheese

Olive Oil
1 teaspoon of salt

Cooking Instructions

This is another easy recipe, sometimes I buy the ready prepared salad from the supermarkets, and stir in two cans of tuna to the pre made salad for a quick and easy tuna salad.

Chopped avocado cubes and parmesan cheese acts as a nice addition. Stir everything together so it breaks up nicely, and add a tablespoon of water and a few sprays of olive oil to keep the salad moist.

Middle Eastern Bulgar Wheat Salad

This is the classic Middle Eastern salad. It is made with cracked wheat also known as bulghur wheat. You'll find these in health food shops as well as in some supermarkets.

Ingredients

85g cracked wheat
1/4 a cucumber
2 salad tomatoes
Half a red onion
1 tablespoon fresh mint
1 tablespoon fresh parsley
1 tablespoon French Dressing
1 tablespoon extra virgin olive oil
1.5 tablespoons freshly squeezed lemon juice
Salt
Black Pepper

Clean Tea Towels

Cooking Instructions

Put the cracked wheat into a bowl and cover it with lots of boiling water. Leave it to soak for 25 minutes.

Tip the cracked wheat into a sieve and drain it really well. Then spoon it into the centre of a clean tea towel and squeeze out all the excess moisture. This step is important or you will end up with a very soggy salad.

Cut your cucumber into small cubes.

Transfer your cracked wheat into a serving bowl, and then stir in the chopped tomatoes(cubed) cucumber(cubed) chopped parsley,

chopped mint, French dressing, olive oil, lemon juice and seasoning and stir well before serving.

Jerk Chicken + Rice

Ingredients

500g Chicken Breasts
100g White Rice
Adobo Seasoning
Jamaican Jerk Seasoning
1 Bell Pepper
Handful Of Kale

Cooking Instructions:

Season the chicken breasts with the adobo and jerk seasonings. Fry the chicken or use an air fryer.

Get 100g of white rice, and boil it in water. Season the water with the adobo seasoning and the Jamaican jerk seasoning too.

Also add 1 sliced bell pepper to the boiling rice. Add a big handful of kale to the boiling rice mixture too. Bring everything to a fast boil. Then turn it down slightly.

Put the lid on to help everything cook together, and turn down the heat down even more slightly once the water level goes underneath the rice.

Cook for a further three minutes. Chop the cooked chicken into cubes. Serve with the Nando's Peri Sauce and some low calorie mayo on top of the chicken. And serve the rice on the side.

Chicken Avocado Quesadilla's

Ingredients

Tortilla Wraps
500g Chicken Breast
100g Mozzarella Cheese

Guacamole Ingredients

2 Avocados.
2 Tomatos.
1 Lemon or 2 Limes
Coriander
Quarter Of A White Onion
Salt to taste

Prepare the guacamole separately in a bowl.

Spray a small amount of oil on the pan, and put in two tortillas folded in half, so that they fit in the pan opposite each other.

Give the tortillas about 20 seconds per side to soak up the oil and cook. Then flip them.

After both sides have been given 20 seconds, you open them up and put some cheese inside. Allow them to cook for a further 30 seconds until the cheese is melting and gooey.

Take them out and put them on a plate. Wait some time for them to cool down a little, and then open them up.

The cheese will glue them together but that is normal, just open them up wide enough to put your guacamole inside.
Put some Nando's sauce on the top if you wish.

Close the tortillas again, and enjoy!

Fitness Tacos

These are tacos without the bread that adds a lot of calories to the meal. We are going to wrap our taco ingredients in lettuce instead.

The larger types of lettuce work best here, I prefer the lettuce called "romaine hearts" instead of "iceberg lettuce" as the romaine hearts are in

the scooped shape of a taco shell and are a more suitable size.

Ingredients

Lettuce
500g Chicken Breast
Chicken Stock Cube
Garlic Salt
Paprika
Black Pepper
Low Fat Cheese (optional)
Jalapeños (optional)
Nandos Peri Sauce (optional)

Guacamole Ingredients

2 Avocados.
2 Tomatoes.
1 Lemon or 2 Limes
Coriander
Quarter Of A White Onion

Salt to taste

Cooking Instructions

Cut your chicken into small cubes. Fry your chicken with a chicken stock cube, garlic salt, paprika, and black pepper.

We are going to create the traditional Mexican guacamole now. Chop two avocados and remove the skin and stone.

Chop the onion and tomatoes into cubes.

Chop a little bit of coriander.

Put some salt and squeeze in the lemons.

Add salt to taste.

Lay out the lettuce “taco shells” on your plate, and serve the chicken inside first.

Then add the guacamole on top. If you need more flavour and have some calories to spare, you can add some low fat cheese, some jalapeño peppers, and some nandos peri sauce on the top.

Tunacado Sandwich

Ingredients

2 Slices Sourdough Bread
4 Eggs

1 Avocado
1 Chopped Tomato
Salt
Jalapeños
Paprika
Greek Yoghurt
Olive Oil
1 Can Of Tuna

Cooking Instructions

Spray a small amount of olive oil onto the pan.

Cook the bread until it is toasted, at around 1 minute per side.

Add some mozzarella cheese to one side of the bread, flip that side so it is face down, and cook the cheese on the bottom of the pan for 10 seconds.

Flip it back over fast before the cheese sets on the bottom of the pan, take the bread and put it on a plate.

Chop the avocado into long strips, and add some salt and jalapeño juice to the top of the avocado.

Stir together the avocado, cubed chopped tomato, and chopped lettuce. Fry 2 eggs per slice of bread, and add some paprika to the top of the fried eggs.

Serve the avocado salad on top of the bread, and then the eggs on top of the avocado.

Fry some tuna in grass fed butter and add some paprika in.

Add the tuna on top of the eggs, and finally, add the jalapeños and the greek yoghurt to complete the tunacado sandwich.

Avocado Toast

Ingredients

2 Slices Sourdough Bread
4 Eggs
1 Avocado
1 Chopped Tomato
Salt
Jalapeños
Paprika
Greek Yoghurt
Olive oil
Cilantro

Cooking Instructions -

Spray a small amount of olive oil onto the pan.

Cook the bread until it is toasted, at around 1 minute per side.

Add some mozzarella cheese to one side of the bread, flip that side so it is face down, and cook the cheese on the bottom of the pan for 10 seconds.

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Chop the avocado into long strips, and add some salt and jalapeño juice to the top of the avocado.

Stir together the avocado, cubed chopped tomato, and chopped lettuce. Fry 2 eggs per slice of bread, and add some paprika to the top of the fried eggs.

Serve the avocado salad on top of the bread, and then the eggs on top of the avocado. Finally put some cilantro on the very top.

Chicken Protein Rice Power Bowl

These bowls are a quick and easy dinner to make. They make you feel very healthy and are full of protein.

Ingredients

500g Chicken Breast
1/4 Of A Cucumber
1 Avocado
2 Tomatoes
1 or 2 Spoons Cottage Cheese
Mexican Flavor Microwave Rice
Stock Chicken Seasoning Cube
Paprika
Cilantro

Cooking Instructions

Cut your cucumber into circles.

Chop your avocado into long strips and remove the stone and skin.

Chop your tomatoes into cubes.

Chop your chicken into cubes.

Fry your chicken with a stock chicken cube and season with paprika.

Microwave your Mexican rice.

Add the rice to the bowl first underneath, and then decorate each side of the bowl with a different food.

Add the cucumber on one side, the chicken on another, the tomatoes on another, and the avocado on another.

Finally add some cottage cheese on top of the chicken, and some cilantro on top of the cottage cheese for some decoration.

Chicken Rice and Vegetable Soup

This soup is amazing for cutting weight
and feeling healthy. You can meal prep large amounts of this healthy soup to last you all week.

Ingredients

Chicken breast 500grams.
1 red tomato.
4l water.
1 teaspoon of salt.
A pinch of fresh coriander.
200grams of rice.
1 chicken stock cube.
1/8th of an onion.

Cooking Instructions

Cut the tomato into 4 pieces.

Cut an onion into an 8th.

Put chicken, tomato and onion in boiling water for 30 minutes.

Put one teaspoon of salt into the water at the last moment.

Remove the ingredients from the boiling water. Keep the boiling water going.

Break up the chicken with your hands after it is boiled.

Get the onion tomato and coriander, and blend it with a blender.

Put back the chicken, blended onion and tomato, and raw rice into the same boiling water.

Cook everything in the water for another 25 minutes, at a medium boil.

The bubbles should be small and slow.

Place into containers a few servings to eat throughout the week ahead.

Mediterranean Fish Parcels

These are an excellent way to oven cook any fish. Whilst salmon can taste great fried in garlic salt and butter, fishes such as cod, sea bass and basa fish often perform better in the oven.

Oven cooked fish is also great if you feel like you want to cut back on fried foods, and you can even use salmon with this recipe too.

Add all of the below ingredients to some aluminium foil and wrap them into a tightly closed bundle:

A Slice Of Your Chosen Fish
A Few Sprays Of Olive Oil
1 Teaspoon Salt
1 Teaspoon Pepper
1 Teaspoon Lemon Juice
5 Capers
5 Olives
Sprinkle Of Dill

You can put each slice of fish in a different aluminium foil bundle, as fish usually comes in 2 or more slices.

In each bundle use 5 capers, 5 olives and the rest of the ingredients.

Place the bundles in the oven and cook at 200degrees for 20 - 25 minutes.

Beef, Sweet Potato, Broccoli

This is another bodybuilding classic. What a lot of people do when they first start to cook their beef and sweet potato bowls, is they make the mistake of putting their sweet potatoes in the oven with no seasoning.

Some people don't even peel the sweet potato before chopping it, so the skin is still attached to some of the cubes. Invest in a potato peeler,

take the two minutes to peel your sweet potatoes, and season them.

For the sweet potatoes, the trick is in the seasoning. If sweet potato tastes boring to you, you are cooking it wrong, as it can taste amazing with the right flavors.

The secret to the seasoning of sweet potatoes is:

- 1 tablespoon of smoked paprika
- 1 tablespoon of onion granules
- 1 tablespoon of garlic salt
- Half a tablespoon of black pepper

Mix all of these seasonings into a bowl and apply to the sweet potatoes with a small amount of olive oil, spray

olive oil works best to keep things low calorie

You can place the sweet potatoes in the oven for 30 minutes or fry them if short on time.

The final secret to the sweet potatoes tasting great is Tabasco sauce, apply some Tabasco sauce on top of the seasoned sweet potatoes.

For your serving of beef, you can fry beef mince. Or you can fry a steak.

Boil your broccoli for 3 minutes.

Serve the beef and sweet potato's with some broccoli.

Naked Burrito

A naked burrito is a form of cheesy rice and chicken. The term naked burrito sounds unhealthy, but it is really just a healthy chicken and rice meal, with some extra cheese and tomato involved.

We apply some natural tomato flavour to the rice using chopped tomatoes, a Mexican seasoning sachet and we also add some extra protein with some cheese.

Ingredients

200g white rice
2 tomatoes
500g chicken breast
75g Grated Mozzarella
1 bell pepper

Maggi Mexican Seasoning Sachet or
Taco Seasoning
Garlic salt
Black pepper
Smoked Paprika
Paprika
Jalapeños
Cilantro

Cooking Instructions

Cook your rice first in a rice cooker or on the stove, so it is ready to go, and then get a pan.

Fry your chicken first, with garlic salt, paprika, smoked paprika, and black pepper.

When the chicken is nearly done, fry some bell peppers for a few minutes.

until you see the edges starting to blister brown.
At this stage, add the cooked rice to the pan and start to stir it in the juices, as well as 2 finely chopped tomatoes that are chopped into very small cubes.

Stir it for a further 3 minutes, to give the tomatoes time to warm up.

At this stage you can also add the powdered Maggi Mexican seasoning sachets, or any form of taco seasoning if you cannot find this brand.

The secret to this meal is the cheese, add some grated mozzarella cheese.

Nowadays stores sell the cheese pre grated for the same price as an equal block of cheese, so I buy mine pre

grated so that this meal does not take long to make.

Add the cheese and stir it around into the rice.
This will create a cheesy, tomato flavoured rice and chicken dish, that can serve as a nice break from the standard chicken rice and broccoli that many bodybuilders eat.

You can even add some jalapeño peppers onto this dish and fresh cilantro on the top.

Green Alkaline Recovery Smoothie

Ingredients:

2 Heaping Tablespoons of Ground Cinnamon

2 Heaping Tablespoons of Vanilla Extract
1 Red or Pink Apple
1 Head of Broccoli
5 Medjool Dates, (remove pips)
1 Green Bell Pepper
1 Cucumber
6 Large Stalks of Celery
12 Ounces of Water
12-15 Cherry Tomatoes
6-10 Strawberries
2 Five-ounce Tubs of Spinach

*This recipe makes 4 smoothies.

Arnold's Super 50 Gram Protein Shake

1 Scoop Whey Protein
2 Eggs

1 Ripe Banana
250ml Milk or Almond Milk
100ml Cherry Juice
1 Serving Greens Powder
Vanilla Extract

If you don't like the eggs, you can use 2 scoops of whey protein instead, and your shake will hit over 50grams of protein.

Recovery Ice Tea

I am going to give you a mix of herbs you can shake and mix together in a tin, which will help you with your recovery. This mixture will make 25 total cups of tea.

½ cup of dried hibiscus
¼ cup of dried chamomile
2 tablespoons of dried lemongrass

2 tablespoons of dried alfalfa
1 tablespoon of dried horsetail

Place them in a jar or tin and shake them until evenly combined.

Place 1 to 3 teaspoons of the mixture into a tea infuser, and place into hot water for 10 minutes.

Then serve it with lots of ice.

Whilst this blend of herbs are generally considered safe, different people react to herbs differently! Check with your doctor and it is not recommended to consume such herbs when pregnant.

Meal Plans

I have included some ***example*** meal plans for balanced, clean, and healthy eating, with separate plans for both men and women.

Male Optimal Diet

Morning Vitamins

Cod Liver Oil 1000mg x2 Daily
Vitamin D3 and K2 10,000iu Daily
Zinc
Magnesium

Diet - Breakfast

Option 1: High Protein Yoghurt Rasberry or Strawberry (20g Protein) w/ handful of Red Grapes (Reduces Estrogen)
Option 2: 3-4 Eggs, Omlette (High Protein and Boosts Testosterone)
Option 3: Protein Pancakes (70g plain flour, 30g Optimum Nutrition Casein vanilla protein powder, 2 large eggs, 300ml milk, 1 tbsp sunflower or vegetable oil and a pinch of salt)

Bananas and blackberries and sugar on top.
Option 4: Protein Porridge (Can buy from internet)
Glass of Whole Milk (High Protein)
Protein Shake 20g Protein

Diet - Lunch

High Protein Meal Deal: 20g Protein Chicken Wrap, Chicken Breast or chicken satay side, 20g Protein Drink
OR Bulgar Wheat Salad, Grilled Chicken Breasts x2. 1 Avacado.
OR Salmon (1 canned or 2 fillets fresh), 1 Avacado
OR Tuna (1 can), 1 avacado
Glass of Whole Milk
Pistachios - Snack
Carrots - Snack
Blueberries - Snack
Beef Jerky or Biltong - Snack

Diet - Dinner

3 Grilled Chicken Breast, Brocolli,
and White Rice
OR Steak, Brocolli, Carrots, 150g
White Rice or Mash Potato
OR Salmon, Brocolli, 150g White Rice

Diet - Drinks

Pomegranate Juice
Healthy Green Smoothies

Other Good Foods

If you are out at restaurants, or just in everyday life, try to go high protein low calories. These are some safe foods:

Mushrooms (Reduce Estrogen)
Oysters (High Protein)
Crab (High Protein)

Pistachios and Brazil Nuts
Always steak, beef, salmon, lamb, chicken, tuna.
Red grapes, blueberries, banana, pomegranate

Foods To Avoid

Sugary Food Donuts, Chocolate, if you must have chocolate have 1 cube of dark chocolate as a treat.
Pringles and crisps
Pot Noodles and Ramen with no nutritional value
McDonalds (High Fat Low Protein)
Alcohol
"Kentucky Fried" Chicken and meats instead of clean cooked meats

Women's Optimal Diet

Diet - Breakfast

Option 1: High Protein Yoghurt Rasberry or Strawberry (20g Protein) w/ handful of Red Grapes (Reduces Estrogen)
Option 2: 2 Eggs, Omlette (High Protein)
Option 3: 2 Protein Pancakes (Mix made with: 70g plain flour, 30g Optimum Nutrition Casein vanilla protein powder, 2 large eggs, 300ml milk, 1 tbsp sunflower or vegetable oil and a pinch of salt) Bananas and blackberries and sugar on top.
Option 4: Protein Porridge (Can buy from internet)
Glass of Whole Milk (High Protein)

Protein Shake 20g Protein

Diet - Lunch

High Protein Meal Deal: 20g Protein Chicken Wrap, Chicken Breast or chicken satay side, 20g Protein Drink
OR 100g Bulgar Wheat Salad, Grilled Chicken Breasts x2. half an Avacado.
OR Salmon (1 canned or 2 fillets fresh), half an Avacado
OR Tuna (1 can), 1 avacado
Glass of Whole Milk
Pistachios - Snack
Carrots - Snack
Blueberries - Snack

Diet - Dinner

2 Grilled Chicken Breast, Broccoli,
and 100g White Rice
OR Steak, Broccoli, Carrots, 100g
White Rice or Mash Potato
OR 2 Salmon fillets, Brocolli, 100g
White Rice

Diet - Drinks

Pomegranate Juice
Healthy Green Smoothies
Pure Orange Juice

Women's Diet Advice

Women generally need fewer calories than men as they are generally smaller and male and female bodies work in **different ways.**

However, women have higher **vitamin and mineral needs** than men — iron and calcium are of particular importance.

In terms of the actual food, you can eat **similarly** to the male meal plans above, just a bit lighter.

For example, you'll notice I use pretty much the **same meal plan** in the male plan for the female meal plan, but I switch out 4 eggs in the omelette for 2.

Where the male plan has 1 avocado, the female plan switches it for half. 150g of white rice for men becomes 100g for women.

The principle is simple, take the same diet with lighter portions, or **match it against your calorie goals.**

Even saying women need to eat less is a generalisation, because some women would have to eat more than men if they were **taller and bigger,** so always match your diet to your calorie calculator when it comes to serving sizes.

For **snacks**, you have plenty of options — some oats in the morning, an apple with peanut butter, or a small amount of sweet potato instead of a large serving of rice with your salmon and broccoli all work well.

Try to hit **1 gram of protein per pound of bodyweight**. Track your calories with an app and adjust every couple of weeks based on what the scale is doing.

Comparing The Common Diets

I'm going to cut through all of the different things that you see on social media, where a "new" super diet comes out every month that people will try and tell you to jump on.

I see that dieting can affect people's mental health more than it needs to. Because we tend to overcomplicate our diet.

Infact, one thing you will learn that is common in my teachings, is that the

more we overcomplicate different areas of our life, the more stressed and lost we feel in general.

Diet is one of those areas. There is always something new and just about believable for us to follow! So we never stay convicted.

We never trust ourselves and we listen to marketing, and that person on our screens with a 6 pack making promises with some kind of new route. It is like an information overload. We need to stand firm.

When I did my PT course, I felt as though the module of nutrition was going to be massively long! I believed I would learn many different diets.

Maybe carnivore only would be better for one type of training? Maybe an alkaline diet was the way! Maybe going vegan wasn't so bad?

We are encouraged nowadays to not know what to do in our diets as we constantly switch between what people tell us.

There are too many options and we feel bad because we don't know if we are picking the right one.

I thought there would be a lot to learn in my nutrition module when learning to be a fitness trainer. But in all honesty, it simplified it down to one thing for me.

Eat a balanced and healthy diet! Every other diet that is not **balanced**

has weaknesses and will surely result in **deficiencies**.

Hit your **protein** targets, go for a **moderate** macros split, and eat **balanced, healthy** food choices.

The guidelines are there and have always been there.

Eat a balanced variety of clean and healthy food and you will start to feel great.

There's no way to complicate it. Social media has done that for us!

After learning this, I haven't looked back since. But to get to this stage, it really helped me to understand ***why*** some of these fad diets do not work.

This gives me the **confidence** that I am on the right track, the **confidence** to say no to someone who tries to change my mind, and I can swipe through my social media and not get **distracted** by 100 different things.

Because I know **the science,** and I know not to fall for the marketing and the “secrets" someone is trying to sell me.

All of what you really need to get in great shape in terms of diet is in this book. There is no secret exotic fruit, breathing exercise, or routine to get you a 6 pack faster than the information in this book.

Mostly, the secret is a **balanced diet, high protein, consistent lifting,** and a **good programme** with a lot of

advanced training techniques and supersets that I have given cool names to keep you interested.

That's where the majority of the **growth** happens! I guess some of this is a big secret to someone who hasn't learned all this. Yes, I still need to tell you the foods that are healthy. But the **secrets** are **less attractive** and marketable than you think! It's nothing **exotic.**

It is mostly the **modern science** from journals that no one can be bothered to read that works!

What if I told you that a person who ate **chicken, rice, and broccoli** daily, who hit their **protein targets** and then did a bunch of **supersets** in the gym from my programme, who ate some

vitamins and fruit portions daily, would look amazing regardless of anything else?

There is a slight bit more to know than this, and a few secrets I can tell you, but **deep down,** you already sort of know the basics, you just get distracted by marketing and trends!

You don't know who is qualified and who is lying. So let me just tell you the science as someone who is at least a qualified PT who has read the journals and modern science.

Anyone I know in **real life** and anyone who I trained who is genuinely in great shape is eating balanced and clean day to day, no matter what magic trend they are trying to sell on their Instagram page.

You will soon understand the science of **why**. Let's look at a few different diet types commonly out there today to help you stay on a balanced and confident path with your diet.

Dirty Bulking

Basically, young men and some women that are new to lifting and specifically with the ectomorphic body type, get told to **dirty bulk.**

The ectomorphic body type starts out skinny, and people want a **shortcut** to get big as they often feel insecure about being skinny.

So people on the internet recommend this trend. It's called dirty bulking because you don't eat clean at all, you eat as much and **whatever you can** to consume ridiculous amounts of calories.

Doughnuts, crisps, high calorie foods. It does make you **put on weight** but it's **nearly all fat.** You become "skinny fat" overtime, which is even worse.

Only **so much** protein can be used, anything more goes to **fat**. So if you overeat you get fat very fast. At higher body fat percentages,(which you will reach because you are fat) your body fat converts more of your testosterone to estrogen.

You **lose testosterone** which helps with muscle gain and increase in

estrogen which is almost the opposite to testosterone. Being fat tends to lower your SHBG which produces testosterone, and causes inflammation which also affects your hormones.

There's something about being fat and unhealthy that just doesn't optimise your hormones such as testosterone to be conducive to building muscle.

Sometimes I think of this like what if we were in the olden days where we were hunting food to survive.

We needed to be very lean and active. When you are lean you are like a machine that can catch and kill any animal.

Your body is primed to grow. Your body knows you are active and in your prime, hunting animals. So it adjusts and sends all the growth signals and hormones.

When you are fat, it’s like your body stops signaling to send you testosterone, you feel lethargic.

It’s like your body knows you're lazy and you're signalling to it that you prefer to laze at home and overeat rather than to be an active hunter.

So it acts accordingly and your body starts to look and perform that way too.

People think because they are big and fat they can lift more weight, and gain

more muscle. But, it doesn't work that way.

Your lifts go up from being heavier, which is why this technique is marketed, but you are not in the correct hormonal environment to make gains or keep them.

No matter your body type or muscle mass, when it is lean it is hormonally primed to be effective in building muscle.

Honestly, you actually feel the difference in energy levels being lean vs fat. You feel it in how you operate in business, and in working out, and in your mood.

When I tried "dirty bulking" I got fat from all the **high-fat** products and

generally just felt terrible eating pastries and doughnuts and **processed** foods.

This is the diet where you just eat what you want and it isn't healthy for your **body or mind.**

There's no element of **discipline** to it, and no feeling of doing good for yourself or your body, what's more, it's just not really **effective** long term.

Carnivore Diet / No Carbs

Carnivore diet is basically a meat only diet. Meat does have **protein** and makes you feel strong and full. But there's no **fruit and veg**, which helps with you not getting sick.

There's no carbs, which drops your insulin balances, leptin balances and affects gym **performance**.

Essentially, I am all for a high meat diet, and believe animal meat does give us a lot of power, but without fruit and vegetables, this diet is a ***mineral deficiency*** waiting to happen.

Importance of Carbs!

When you cut out carbs, your body has to completely switch **fuel systems** — insulin drops, stress hormones rise, electrolytes shift, and your thyroid and energy levels can dip.

Your body can get through short workouts fine relying on just fat and protein, but relies more on glycogen for longer more intense workouts.

When we don't take carbs, our body switches fuel systems to fat and protein over glycogen, as there is limited glycogen left.

Some people handle this fine, but many feel weak, tired, or mentally foggy during intense training.

Without carbs, your glycogen stores stay low, which hurts energy, endurance, and performance — especially in sports that rely on repeated bursts of power.

The best long-term health outcomes in research consistently come from

balanced diets with a mix of protein, healthy fats, and smart carbs — not from cutting out an entire food category.

This is why carnivore is not sustainable for a serious athlete in my opinion. You can get 70% of the way there on it, but without carbs your heavy strength lifts in the gym will likely suffer.

A lot of people ask about training fasted vs unfasted too. Why do a lot of people have apples or carbs before a workout?

The answer is that if you are just going for a short morning run of half an hour or so, it's ok to train fasted in this situation.

Jogging, light cardio, technique drills, warmups — your body can fuel these mostly with **fat**, so glycogen isn't essential.

But after a long day of not eating, or before an intense exercise session that will last an hour or more, it is best to eat, and especially carbs! Because of glycogen.

Here are some sports where glycogen is essential:

-HIIT
-Boxing / MMA Classes
-Heavy lifting sessions,
-Long distance running
-Hard conditioning circuits
-Football Games / Team Sports

These are all long session type sports that require a lot of endurance!
This is *why* fighters, runners, athletes and lifters often perform worse on zero-carb diets.

To summarise, carbs are a macro and part of a healthy diet. Fruits and vegetables are also responsible for a healthy diet, therefore a carnivore diet **lacks** in these areas.

Extreme Low-Calorie Diets (VLCDs)

- Typically **<800 calories/day**
- Dangers:
    - Hair loss
    - Muscle loss

    - Metabolic slowdown
    - Nutrient deficiencies
    - Gallstones
- Not sustainable; rebound weight gain is common

Avoid these! I don’t think I've ever gone below 800 calories if I am honest. Maybe at one point where I was in the final stage of cutting for my 6 pack in a Thailand fight camp, but I still would have over 800.

And I wouldn't last more than a day. Why?

You just feel too weak, all your lifts drop, and your mood is bad. Remember I said your mood is bad and you feel a bit lazy and weak when you're too fat?

It's a similar feeling, but on the other end of the spectrum! You feel weak because you're not getting **enough** food.

Also, when you lose weight at a rate of more than 1kg per week, you can start to **lose muscle** alongside it.

Don't do **extreme** diets.

Mono Diets

Mono Diets are kind of like carnivore diets, where people tell you to just eat one thing. Such as only potatoes, or grapefruits and things like this. You will lack essential nutrients, cause deficiencies, and regret it! Don't do it!

Dry Fasting

Dry fasting is fasting, but without water too. Even a few hours without water can slightly **dehydrate you**, especially if you're active or in hot climates.

No strong scientific evidence shows extra health benefits from skipping water in short-term fasting.

It can lead to **headaches, dizziness, or fatigue**. Avoid it. Of course there are religious periods where some choose to do this. But for sustained periods of time, it is dangerous in combination with the fitness lifestyle.

Also avoid extended ***3 day fasts.***

Long-Term Fasting / Extended Water Fasts (3+ days)

- Can cause:
  - Electrolyte imbalance
  - Muscle breakdown
  - Hypoglycemia
  - Hormonal disruption
- Short intermittent fasting is safe, but long fasts are not.

Alkaline Diets

This one isn't bad per say. Actually, another coach taught me this diet.

Essentially, you make a lot of green alkaline smoothies and try to avoid acidic foods.

His argument was that acidic foods are responsible for inflammation and disrupt our bodies PH level, and when we become too acidic, it leads to negative outcomes in our body.

I do admit that drinking these green alkaline smoothies full of green healthy vegetables is good.

I'm not against that. And I believe this is the reason the user of the diet was feeling great!

I think this is more to do with increased clean and healthy eating, increased vegetable

intake and general clean eating, as opposed to specifically cutting out all acidic food.

I myself personally wouldn't cut out acidic foods, for example fresh orange juice and oranges. These have an incredibly high amount of vitamin C which helps prevent you from getting ill!

I have many oranges and I honestly can't remember the last time I got ill since starting eating them. I honestly never get ill.

When I do get ill it's never for a long time, it's more like I feel it starting after a night of drinking alcohol, and then just have a bunch of oranges and my usual

vitamin stack, and it disappears fast.

So yes, drink green smoothies, but also have healthy acidic foods such as oranges, lemons. Limiting your diet solely based on Ph is more restrictive.

No Carb / Keto

Keto was talked about in a previous chapter, it's essentially when you cut out carbs and put yourself into ketosis.

Your body switches to fat as its fuel storage instead of carbs.

Many find keto restrictive, but many also claim to see great weight loss results from it.

There are a lot of great bodies being made on Keto diets, but again no carbs strictly means deficiencies can present themselves if you are not careful.

Finally, if you are an athlete needing to perform, then carbs are thought necessary.

High Protein Diet

A balanced, healthy diet, with no limitations aside from hitting your protein intake of 1

gram per pound of bodyweight, and sometimes more for competition lifters.

You aim to hit your protein target in a day, whilst keeping all the other macros moderately balanced.

There are **no restrictions** in food types. But the aim is to eat **clean** overall.

This diet is **great** for fitness, it makes you feel great, the protein keeps you full, and there are options for fibrous foods, and vegetables that also keep your stomach full whilst having low calories, so it's a **good diet** for staying in **lean** shape.

Nowadays, high protein options are in abundance, and affordable.

You have **protein shakes** too to help you hit your targets.

These can contain sugar, so try to get your protein mostly from your meals and using natural sources at meal times, but yes, you can use shakes too as long as you aren't **overconsuming** sugar.

There are further diets such as mediterranean, low carb, and keto.

These are the big names you hear, but can overcomplicate what is necessary to achieve a healthy body in most cases.

Essentially, when it comes to fitness, I noticed most people just refer to their diet as “eating clean” over a specific name, they eat balanced and healthy food that is proven to work in a fitness and health context.

They tend to eat the things I mention in my diet plans in abundance.

To put a label on the **best diet** for optimal health, I can say a high protein diet with a moderately balanced macros, consisting of fruits, vegetables, nuts, healthy fats, and clean eating will not let you down.

Scientifically speaking, this works the best for the majority, is safe, and from all I have seen,

I can tell you it feels the best for the average client..

Intermittent Fasting

This is more of a diet technique than a diet itself. You fast in the morning and are allowed a water or a black coffee. With no sugar or cream.

Fasting is where you don't eat until a **certain time**. You can set different time periods.

I like a modified version of intermittent fasting, where you wake up in the morning, drink a lot of water to stay hydrated, and then try not to eat your first meal until around **2 - 3pm.**

Basically, past 3pm, I find half the day has already gone, and my stomach only has space for a **limited amount** of food at this point.

I will likely only eat a lunch at this point, and once that digests, a dinner. Then I will likely be asleep before my stomach has space for another meal.

This brings me down from a **certain** 3 meals a day if I have breakfast, to around 2 meals if I last until about 3pm and skip breakfast.

This is **excellent** for dieting.

As my stomach can only hold a certain amount of food, there's a limit to how many calories I can get in just 2 meals, especially after 3pm.

I simply can’t eat loads like how I could if I started from the moment I woke up. This technique is actually how I stay lean and it is great for weight loss.

Sure, I might have breakfast some days, such as a protein shake, or a protein meal such as some eggs and a tiny scoop of rice.

Especially if I'm going for a heavy morning gym session with intense long duration cardio included.

But, I try to stay away from heavy carbohydrate sugar heavy breakfasts. A little white rice is ok, or a small serving of rice cakes or a protein yoghurt.

The reasoning behind it is that when you take breakfast, the body kickstarts its hunger mechanism in the stomach.

Your stomach literally sends signals that it's active once you start to eat for the day.

You start getting these hunger signals and start eating everything like a machine.

And if you start eating breakfast, that digests in time for lunch, and in time for dinner. You end up having a lot **more time and space** for meals and food.

Whereas if you keep your first meal later on in the day, it only has a few hours to digest before you are asleep,

you can't really have space for more than that one meal. You end up eating less and then falling asleep.

You also don't get a food crash or that heavy sleepy feeling you get after meals. I do my business work in the first half of the day fasted for **improved concentration** for this reason.

Intermittent fasting is an acceptable technique to use, provided the fasting windows are not extreme.

Bulks, Cuts, Maintenance

Cutting vs Bulking, What To Do?

There are three options when it comes to managing your body composition: cutting, bulking, and maintenance.

Understanding when and how to use each one is fundamental to building the best possible physique.

Here is exactly how I approach this with every client.

Note that all guidelines below are general — every individual is different.

The Three Phases

Cutting

Timeframe: 6–12 weeks

Cutting means eating in a calorie deficit in order to lose body fat. Cuts should generally be slightly faster than bulks — if you cut for too long, you risk losing muscle.

However, you must cut within reason. Losing more than 1kg per week typically results in muscle loss, so the goal is a controlled, disciplined deficit.

Rate of Loss:

- Target 0.5–1kg of weight loss per week.

- A mini-cut lasts around 6 weeks. A full cut lasts around 12 weeks.
- Do not starve yourself — eat clean, pick up your cardio, and keep lifting heavy.

Macros:

- Keep protein at 1g per pound of bodyweight to protect muscle.
- Aim for roughly 30% protein, 45% carbs, 25% fat — though protein is the non-negotiable.

Refeed Days:

As long as your weekly average is in a deficit, you can include one day per week where calories are slightly

higher. For example, eating at 1,500 calories daily but having a 2,000-calorie Saturday.

On this day, increase your carbohydrate intake and train heavier — you will have more energy to take advantage of. This is not a cheat day to binge; it is a controlled, strategic refeed.

Do 1 - 2 per week and do them on your heavy days, which is usually upper body days for men and lower body days for women.

Bulking

Timeframe: 8–16 weeks

Bulking means eating in a slight calorie surplus in order to build muscle. The goal is to maximise the time spent in a muscle-building phase by keeping that surplus small and clean. Your body can only use a limited amount of energy to build muscle at any one time — anything beyond that goes to fat.

Strategy:

- Only add calories when your lifts are stalling. Keep increases subtle to avoid gaining fat prematurely.

- Stay within the athletic body fat ranges: 10–15% for men, 18–24% for women.
- Once you leave those ranges, your hormonal environment shifts — estrogen rises, testosterone drops — and muscle building becomes less efficient.

Avoid Dirty Bulking:

Eating everything in sight does not build more muscle — it builds more fat. This forces a longer, harder cut, which risks losing the muscle you worked to gain.

A slow, clean bulk keeps you in the optimal zone for as long as possible.

The dirty bulk is a shortcut that takes you backwards.

Maintenance

Timeframe: 2 weeks – indefinitely

Maintenance means eating at the calories your body needs to stay at its current weight. It is used for three purposes:

- To recover from diet fatigue and training fatigue before a cut or bulk.
- To recompose your body — building muscle slowly while staying lean, without a formal bulk or cut.

- To sustain your physique long-term if you are happy with your body composition.

Maintenance can last from a minimum of 2 weeks to indefinitely. It is particularly valuable after a long cut, or whenever you feel diet or training fatigue from a long cut creep in.

Further tips for cutting:

1. **Cuts should generally be slightly more aggressive than bulks.** If you cut for long periods of time, you risk losing muscle, and cutting isn't the

best environment to build muscle.

However, you must cut within reason—losing more than **1kg** a week typically results in muscle loss.

2. **Refeed Days:** As long as your weekly average is in a deficit, you can have one day where calories are slightly higher (e.g., eating **2000** calories on Saturday vs. **1500** the rest of the week).

This is known as a refeed, eat an increased amount of carbohydrates on this day.

This provides extra energy for a heavier gym day and you should go

heavier in the gym on this day as you will benefit from more energy.

Note this is **not** a "cheat day" to stuff your face, it is a controlled day of more eating.

Eat clean, maintain your cardio, and keep lifting on the same program in the same ranges.

The main thing that changes in a cut is that you reduce calories.

3. **Do not do tons of cardio at the expense of skipping weight sessions, or drastically change programs and rep ranges.**

Reason: What worked for you in the bulk to build muscle will help you retain it on your cut. A cut is the

worst time to experiment with a potentially less optimal program!

4. Stay on a good bodybuilding programme and do the normal amount of cardio, control your weight mainly through your diet.

Reason: Too much cardio takes a very long time and you want to spend that time on your weights sessions to maintain muscle in your cut.

It can take 3 hours just to burn 1000 calories, whereas it takes no time out of your day all to be disciplined with your diet.

Some competition level bodybuilders reach extremely low competition levels of body fat, through diet alone,

or a half an hour a day of stair master cardio.

You don't need to run marathons if you control your diet. The commonly recommended practice is to do 30 minutes to 1 hour of zone 2 cardio after your gym sessions.

If you want to retain muscle on your cut, you have to balance lifting and cardio.

Especially if you are doing things like kickboxing or marathon running, you will loose weight fast, but in terms of keeping muscle, you have to maintain a good ratio of lifting to cardio to get ideal results.

Further Tips For Bulking

The goal is to maximize the time spent in a muscle-building phase by keeping your calorie surplus **small and clean**.

Our bodies can only use a limited amount of protein and energy to build muscle at any one time; anything extra is stored as fat.

If you bulk too fast or "dirty bulk," you'll gain fat quickly, which forces you to end the building phase early to go on a long cut.

The Strategy: Only add calories when you feel your lifts are stalling. By keeping the surplus subtle, you avoid

the hormonal shift (rising estrogen) that comes with high body fat.

The Look: Stay within the athletic ranges (**10–15%** for men, **18–24%** for women). This keeps your body primed to build muscle and keeps you looking fit year-round.

The Trap: Avoid "dirty bulking." It builds bad habits, ruins your hormonal profile, and makes the eventual cut long and miserable.

Further Tips For Maintenance

Maintenance is the "**secret sauce**" of the AG System, especially for the first **2–3 years** of training.

While many coaches insist on **constant bulking and cutting**, I've found that most clients can stay at maintenance and successfully "recompose"—losing fat and gaining muscle simultaneously.

- **Recomposition:** Stay at your maintenance calories within the athletic body fat zone. As you get stronger and build muscle, your body's energy requirements will naturally increase.

- **The 100-Calorie Bump:** When your lifts eventually stall, it's a sign your body has grown muscle, likely your maintenance is now a little

higher because more muscles means you burn more calories. Add **100 calories** to find your "new maintenance" and repeat the process.

- **Longevity:** This method can be used for **2 weeks** to recover from diet and strength fatigue, or **indefinitely** to build a great shape steadily without ever needing a harsh diet.

Using Maintenance To Break Up A Cut

If you have been on a long cut where your lifts are **starting to suffer** (dropping more than 1 rep per week across your lifts is usually a sign your body is getting tired) you can implement a maintenance period to get your lifts and strength back.

Maintenance can be used to split a really **long cut into two.**

For example if a competition bodybuilder male needed to get down from 20% body fat to a stage lean 7% body fat, he may first decide to do a cut to 15% and stay at **maintenance** there to recoup strength, before

tackling the final competition preparation cut down to 7%.

The AG Method: Maintenance Gaining

While many coaches push constant bulking and cutting cycles from **day one**, my experience working with clients revealed something different — especially in the first two to three years of training.

Many coaches say that it is **impossible** to build muscle and loose fat at the same time. Many coaches say that you have to bulk and cut to get serious results.

When I evaluated a lot of my clients, I found that most people, when they

first start lifting seriously, can build muscle and lose fat **simultaneously** simply by eating at maintenance and training hard.

Contrary to what many coaches say, this is not only possible — but for beginners and intermediates, it is often the most **effective** method.

I noticed many clients that did not bulk or cut simply maintain their weight on the scale, however their **body fat** reading on their scans showed a **reduction** in body fat.

The scans also picked up **more lean body mass**. What this meant is that they **gained muscle** and **lost fat**, all whilst staying at the same weight.

I could consistently see around a 5 - 10% decrease in body fat and around an 5 -10kg increase in muscle per year in clients.

For my **AG4 clients** I suggest a client spend their first 2 years of training at the calories that will maintain their weight in the athletic body fat zone.

I tell the client to only increase their calories every once in a while when their lifts are **stalling.**

If lifts are stalling, It is likely the fact that their body has grown muscle and therefore requires more calories to maintain, so their maintenance has **gone up** slightly.

The client will add **100 calories** to reach their new maintenance calories. They repeat this process **year round,** with no harsh cuts or bulks, and they build great shape.

I call this the **Maintenance Gaining** System.

How It Works

The principle is straightforward:

- Set your calories at the level that maintains your weight within the athletic body fat zone.
- Train consistently, hit your protein targets, and focus on getting stronger.
- When your lifts stall, add 100 calories.

- This stalling is a signal — your body has likely grown muscle, which now requires slightly more energy to maintain. Your maintenance has gone up.
- Add those 100 calories, find your new maintenance, and repeat the process.

Over time, your maintenance calories slowly rise as you become more muscular. You are building muscle, burning fat, and staying lean — all at the same time.

Why It Works

Beginners have a **significant** physiological advantage: the body responds powerfully to resistance

training when it is **new** to that stimulus.

Muscle can be built even without a calorie surplus in these early stages, provided **protein intake** is **high** and training is consistent.

By staying in the athletic body fat range throughout, your hormonal environment remains optimal. Testosterone stays high, estrogen stays in check, and insulin sensitivity is strong.

This is the most **productive** environment for muscle growth.

Your First Two Years

My **recommendation** for anyone new to training is this: get yourself to the **athletic** body fat range first, and then spend your first two years building your body from there.

Do not **rush** into aggressive cuts and bulks.

- Get lean enough that you can see your physique clearly and identify your weak points.
- Eat to maintain that leanness, hit your protein targets, and train hard.
- Add 100 calories only when lifts stall.

- If body fat creeps above the athletic range, do a short, sharp cut back down.
- Repeat this process patiently.

Most people in their first two years **do not** need **aggressive** cuts or bulks. They need consistency, protein, and progressive overload in an optimal hormonal environment.

Maintenance Gaining provides all of that.

Past the two-year mark — once you have a solid base of muscle, and real experience managing your diet — more structured bulking and cutting cycles can be introduced if needed to bring up specific **weak points** or to prepare for competition.

Who Should Cut, Bulk, or Maintain?

Normal Male Athletes & Casual Gym-Goers:

"I am noticeably over 15–20% body fat."

Cut. Your body needs to be in a good hormonal state to build optimum muscle. Get yourself into the athletic range first.

"I am at 10% body fat with abs and I feel great."

If you want more **muscle** and have noticeable weak points, you can lean

bulk in cycles going between 10–15% body fat.

This allows you to build muscle while staying in **optimal** condition.

If your lifts are still going up and muscle is visibly growing on **maintenance**, or you are simply happy with your physique, you can also simply eat at maintenance calories.

"I am skinny fat."

Eat at the maintenance calories that keep your stomach flat, and recompose your body through consistent training for one to two years.

As a beginner, you can gain muscle effectively without a formal bulk. If lifts stall, add a slight surplus, but do not exceed 15% body fat.

Build your base first.Stay in the optimal athletic range and build your body for 2 years on the AG program.

If you use bulks and cuts do not exceed the 10 - 15% body fat range.

I have been cutting for over 16 weeks and my progress has stalled. I went from 25% body fat down to 16%. I really want a six pack, but my lifts are starting to suffer consistently, and I keep having binge weeks one week and then cut calories really hard the next to make up for it. I have been in circles for a while now.

Take a maintenance break of at least 2–3 weeks. Allow yourself some enjoyable food without bingeing, and avoid high-sugar foods that trigger cravings. When your lifts begin rising again and your mental energy and motivation have recovered, you can return to the cut.

I have cut from 30% down to 10% and I am scared to bulk again. I am not 100% happy with my muscle, but my 6 pack is showing and for the first time in my life I am confident with how I look. I do want more muscle, but I am scared to put on weight again because I used to be so obese.

This is completely **understandable**. Spend time at **maintenance** to adjust your body and mind to this new way

of living. Build muscle slowly here, without pressure.

It is only when you feel genuinely **in control**, confident, and ready that you should consider bulking. There is no rush.

Build the belief in yourself that you have the ability to stay at a low body fat and build healthy eating as an **undeniable** part of your lifestyle, when you feel confident to bulk do some **smaller** ones first and stay within the athletic ranges!

Everyday Female Athletes & Casual Gym-Goers

I am noticeably over 24–30% body fat.

Cut. Get your body into a healthy hormonal state before focusing on muscle building.

I am lean at 18–20% body fat and happy with my look.

Maintain and recompose. Stay here, keep lifting, and hit protein targets. If lifts stall and you wish to develop specific areas like glutes or shoulders, a slight clean bulk up to no more than 24% body fat is appropriate.

I am skinny fat.

Eat to maintain a flat stomach, recompose your body through lifting for one to two years, and reassess. If

you do bulk and cut, keep it within the 18–24% range and build slowly. Build your base first.

I have been on a long cut and my progress has stalled.

Go to maintenance for at least 2–3 weeks. Allow your training fatigue and diet fatigue to subside before resuming. When your lifts are going up again and your motivation has returned, you can cut again.

I have cut down and I am scared to bulk again due to previous obesity.

The same principle applies as the above example for men. Spend time at maintenance to build belief in your ability to stay lean. Build slowly without pressure.

Build healthy eating as an undeniable part of who you are until you are so confident this is the new you.

Take your time. After you feel confident, start with small and shorter bulks first that are easy to recover from, and always try to stay in your athletic range!

Male Competitors

Competition cutting and bulking is slightly more extreme. Competitors whether natural or not, tend to bulk and cut in **longer** cycles.

Some muscle loss is **expected** when cutting in such an **extreme** way but,

this is just the way it works with the human body.

A competitor has to build a lot of muscle in a higher range of body fat where they can build **effectively**, and then they must diet down for a long period of time into **single digit** body fat to make their body look great for a competition.

It takes a long time to diet down into **single digit** body fat and is no easy task! Muscle is also harder to cling to in that range.

Here are the two common scenarios in competition:

I am on my off season and have no competitions in the next few months.

If you are on your off season, you generally lean bulk and build muscle but try to maintain under 15% body fat.

I am 12 - 30 weeks out from my competition.

If you are 12-30 weeks out from a competition, you generally cut and start to prepare.

If you are already 10 - 12% body fat, you can do this in one cut. If you are 20% body fat, you may wish to leave more time to do your cut.

You could do a **pre-prep** cut to reach 10 - 12% body fat. Spend 2 - 3 weeks at maintenance, and then go for the main cut within 12 - 18 weeks of the contest.

This would require the timing of around 32 weeks to factor in the Pre Cut of around 16 weeks, the maintenance of 3 weeks, and the final cut of 14 weeks.

Female Competitors

Here are the two common scenarios:

I am on my off season and have no competitions in the next few months.

If you are on your off season, lean bulk and build muscle, try to stay under 24% body fat throughout the off season.

I am 12 - 30 weeks out from my competition.

If you are 12-30 weeks out from a competition, you generally cut and start to prepare.

If you are already 18 - 20% body fat, you can do this in one cut. If you are 24 - 28% body fat, you may wish to leave more time.

You could do a **pre prep** cut, reach 18 - 20% body fat. Spend 2 - 3 weeks at maintenance, and then go for the main cut within 12 - 18 weeks of the contest.

This would require the timing of around 32 weeks to factor in the Pre Cut of around 16 weeks, the

maintenance of 3 weeks, and the final cut of 14 weeks.

Competition prep is a **serious** undertaking and requires an **experienced** coach.

Competition Dieting

Dieting time is different for competitions where the competitors do cut for longer than 12 weeks, they cut for around 20 weeks and sometimes more.

But they do this because they have to for extreme competitions. They need to get to really low levels of fat that aren't necessary to look great.

They actually loose muscle by going down so low in body fat, and it's more **optimal** for the average man or woman who just wants an **aesthetic,** healthy body to cut in **shorter** intervals than this.

You can literally see veins coming out of these competitors, and it isn't considered the most aesthetic amongst everyday society, it is just for a competition.

These competitors go from 10-15% body fat to 7% as men, or from 18 - 20% to 10% body fat as women.

This takes a long time as body fat takes longer to loose once you enter

single digits as a man and near 10% for women.

To peak in the these ranges, they have to first be at an athletic range, and then do 20 week controlled cuts in many cases with **professional** coaches and strategic break weeks.

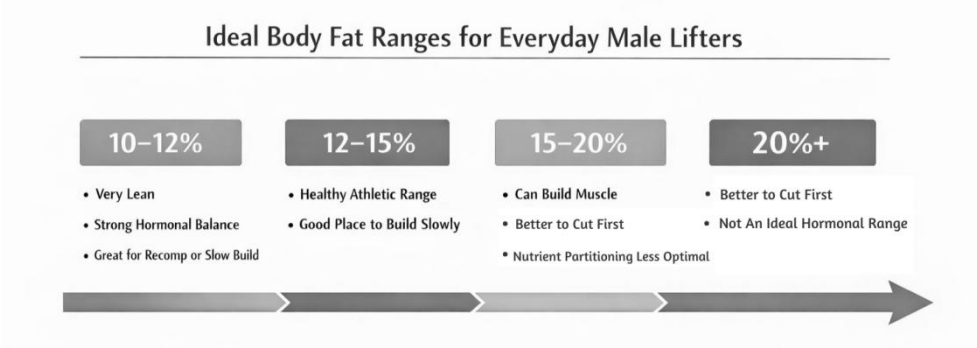
If you are ever thinking of competing, make sure you get a professional coach, and make sure you know what you are in for.

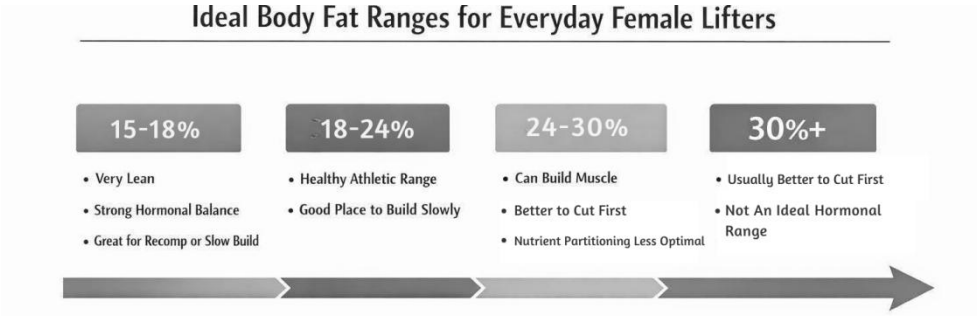
These low body fat ranges for men and women cause extreme **hormonal changes**, mood swings, missed periods for women, low testosterone and libido for men, and overall you have to have a **strong mind** to not attract eating disorders when you eat so **extremely**.

At AG Training I am a proposer of staying within a healthy, athletic body fat range to prevent eating disorders and to keep you healthy and happy, and whilst I think competing is cool if that's what a person wants to do, I suggest that competitors know what they sign up for and don't take it **lightly**!

The Athletic Range

The best possible **range for building muscle** is within 10 - 15% body fat for a man, and 18 - 24% for a woman, on a very slight calorie increase.





So you want to drag out your time and build in these areas as long as possible.

The very worst time to build muscle is on **long cuts,** repeated cuts, and **body fat percentages that are outside of the athletic ranges**, which is where dirty bulking or extreme dieting will take you.

If you drag out your time in athletic ranges of body fat on calorie surpluses just large enough to see **muscle gain and progress**, you will likely spend the most time of your year in this region, growing an insanely good body.

Getting fat is simply not the most **productive** use of your time, because

if you have to diet for a long period of time, you loose muscle. And the longer you stay in high fat ranges, the more your body produces **estrogen** and your insulin sensitivity drops.

To explain this to a casual person, this is a **hormonal cocktail** that leads to your muscles not being built well.

This is the case whether you are a man or a woman. Men loose testosterone, women gain oestrogen, both gain **fatigue** and **low mood.**

People do these dirty bulking style diets because there are stories on **social media** or in our gyms, of some people doing massive “dirty bulks” eating everything in sight and then cutting back down and seeing amazing results.

This sometimes works for competitive bodybuilders who use drugs, and it can work loosely for the kind of people who have amazing genetics and naturally are quite muscular anyway, they may diet down and see **some** change.

But, the **average** person stands no chance to build the best amount of muscle in those higher body fat zones.

So what is the ultimate AG eating strategy?

The strategy is to eat a clean and healthy diet, staying within the athletic ranges of body fat. You should eat at calories that maintain your weight if you are happy with

your body or you are still growing muscle at these calories.

Increase your calories when your lifts stop improving and if you still want to make changes to your body. Only increase your calories slightly and with clean food.

The aim is to drag your bulk out with clean food so you can spend time in this muscle building phase for your body.

You want to stay in the **athletic** body fat ranges that we talked about in previous sections.

Cycle between around 10 - 15% body fat for men and 15 - 22% for women.

You judge **body fat** by the look of your body. Compare yourself to the pictures of the body fat estimations we have provided online in the "Aesthetic Body Case Study" Youtube video.

What about photoshoots, sports games?

If you have photoshoots, or sports games and seasons, you may make the **choice** to bulk or cut.

For example rugby player or wrestler might bulk to put on size for their sport.

A boxer or football player might **cut** and do extra cardio if they have a

season coming up and then bulk in the off season for strength and muscle gain.

You should **check with your coach** for your chosen sport about the time periods to bulk or cut.

Will the AG System work for me? I am just a regular person and I just want the model type physique.

Definitely, this course is aimed around regular people trying to achieve the aesthetic physique.

Eat at your rough maintenance calories to maintain at a weight within the athletic ranges, whilst

lifting and completing your normal programme.

This way you stay mostly lean and in great shape year round, there is no off season so to speak.

This can be great and is a valid option but muscle gain takes a little more time this way. The trade off is you always look great and are ready for athletic sports.

In reality, a lot of fit people's life looks like this.

They stay in the athletic body fat range they are happy with, they lift and try to beat their records, and when they see themselves creep up over a certain body fat, they focus on

dieting back down again until the **abs** or **flat stomach** returns.

As long as you are consistent in the gym, eat clean, raise your calories slightly and subtly in your harsher training blocks of when you feel like you need to progress a certain lift, you can make progress.

You can take advantage of how your body works and build a great model type body without any kind of extreme dieting.

Cardio, Lifting & Diet — Getting the Balance Right

When people ask what matters most for **losing fat** and **looking great,** the honest answer is that all three elements are required:

- **Resistance training** — building and maintaining muscle.
- **Diet** — the single most controllable factor for body composition.
- **Cardio** — the tool that amplifies everything else.

Lifting and diet are the non-negotiables.

Cardio is built around them, not the other way around.

You can build close to 90% of a great physique through **lifting and diet alone**.

But for most natural lifters, cardio is the missing piece that reveals the abs, creates the additional calorie burn that makes dieting more **manageable**, and keeps the heart and lungs healthy. Done correctly, it **adds** to your results. Done **excessively**, it eats into your muscle and undermines your lifting.

A good rule of thumb: 45–60 minutes of cardio per day, on top of your lifting programme.

For **ectomorphic** types who struggle to build muscle, lean toward the lower end.

For **endomorphic** types who hold both muscle and fat more easily, slightly more cardio can help.

Never let cardio interfere with your weight training sessions.

Cardio burns extra calories, which allows you to eat slightly more. More **food** means more protein, better fuelled sessions, and better muscle retention.

Used that way, it genuinely contributes to building a better body — not just burning it down.

The balance, as always, comes back to the fundamentals: lift consistently, eat clean and hit your protein, and use cardio as a supporting tool.

Get all three working together and the results will follow. Some bodybuilders rely solely on diet, showing that its possible not to use cardio for a great looking body. If your the type to run too many marathons, your muscle gain can be negatively affected.

I believe we should always place a priority on lifting, however don't skip cardio as it is extremely healthy for our hearts, minds and lungs.

Your First Diet

The first cut you go on, it is going to be hard to put a timeframe on your cut.

There is ALWAYS going to be guessing involved. Don't worry if you feel slightly out of your depth.

You likely won't know the exact calorie amount you need to take in to drop weight at your target rate.

As a rule, try and reduce your calories by 250 calories at a time and see how much you loose each week.

If you loose more than 1kg a week, adjust and eat a little more by around 250 calories.

If you loose less than 0.5kg a week, then adjust and eat a little less by around 250 calories.

We aim to loose **0.5 - 1kg a week** as that is generally **safe** for keeping our muscles. (for men).

For women this number is more like **0.25 - 0.5kg a week.**

Keep your protein at 1 gram of protein per lb of body weight to **protect** your muscle.

For women, this number can be **0.8 grams** but to make **counting** your protein intake **easier**, you may wish to just keep things at 1g.

Keep lifting heavy in the gym with the same routine and the same cardio schedule.

Don't do lots of **high reps**, or lighten your weights. Keep lifting in the range of 8 - 12 reps. Work **just as hard** if not harder than you did when you were bulking.

If your body fat is 20% as a man a realistic target is **16 - 20 weeks** until you get to 10-12%. It can take longer or shorter depending on the individual.

If your body fat is 24% as a woman a realistic target is **16 - 20 weeks** to get down to 15 - 17%.

Note that cutting from 20% body fat down to a lean body of 10 - 12% body

fat is a **longer** cut than going from 15% for example as a man.

Or 24% to 15% as a woman is a lot longer of a cut than going from 20% to 15%.

This longer cut carries a **slightly higher** risk of muscle loss.

If you were in this situation, if you wanted to, you could **break your cut up** into two smaller cuts and eat at maintenance for 4 weeks once you reached the mid point.

For example a man could reach a **midpoint** of 15% body fat and a woman could reach 20% body fat in their first cuts.

A 4 week **maintenance** break at this stage can be used as the body fat levels are no longer in the range of body fat where hormones are negatively effected. It is a great area to **maintain** and give the body and mind a slight rest.

Some people may wish to **keep going** and not do a maintenance break, even on a long cut, because they have **momentum** and see the results.

They get **excited** and keep going, because they want to see their abs really badly, sometimes for the first time in their life. This is also **acceptable**.

If your body fat is 15% a realistic target is **12 weeks** until you get to 10 - 12% as a man.

And as a woman if your body fat is 20% a realistic target is **12 weeks** until you get to 15-17%.

Keep your protein high. You have to stay lifting on the same programme that you know has been growing you muscle. Now is not the time to make massive changes.

Do not do loads of cardio and stop lifting, you will just get soft and the scale will go down but your body will go soft and weak. Stay lifting.

Example Cutting Meal Plan 1 (Standard Cut):

1L water as soon as you wake up, this helps you feel full. Most of the time

the body it thinks it needs food, but it actually needs water.

Breakfast:

2 - 4 scrambled eggs (uses the cholesterol to produce testosterone)

Avocado (healthy fats) with a bit of tabasco sauce.

Black coffee - suppresses your appetite until lunch.

Pre Workout Snack:

Banana, mango, watermelon - natural sugars help with your workout

Lunch:

100g Brown rice, 200g chicken or beef with broccoli and mixed veg. No afternoon slump.

Dinner:

200g basa fish. Very low calories. Sweet potatoes diced in the oven with the basa. Asparagus and broccoli with some tabasco sauce.

Cutting for Photoshoots & Competitions

The approach for a **photoshoot** cut is the same as any other cut — stay on your programme, keep lifting, eat clean, and hit **protein** targets.

Do not **suddenly** switch to **all cardio** and **stop lifting.** You will go soft, lose strength, and look worse on the day.

Photoshoot Week Nutrition

5 Days Out

- Drink 3 litres of water daily (or as much as you can comfortably manage).
- Cut carbohydrates for the first 2 days — focus on chicken, eggs, fish. No rice or pasta.
- Continue to lift heavy

3 Days Out

- Continue 3 litres of water.

- Begin reintroducing carbohydrates: rice, rice cakes, honey, jam, chicken breast, cod, vegetables.
- Reduce training load — lift moderately, no heavy sessions.

Night Before

- Maintain 3 litres of water.
- Keep carbohydrates coming in steadily.

Day Of

- Use the toilet in the morning and again 30 minutes before shooting.

- Do a light pump workout 30 minutes before — sets of 20 reps

with bands, bodyweight push-ups. No heavy lifting or cardio (this depletes glycogen and flattens your muscles).

- Drink only 1–2 small cups of water in the morning; sips only throughout the shoot.

- Eat a small breakfast: cod, white fish or chicken breast, white rice or unsalted rice cakes, a small amount of peanut butter.

- Do not add table salt.

- Avoid high-sugar carbohydrates on the day — they spike insulin, cause cravings, and can leave you looking bloated. Slow-release carbohydrates like sweet

potatoes and rice are ideal in the days leading up.

- Avoid trans fats (processed foods, doughnuts, margarine) in the final days — combined with fast carbs, they promote fat storage and leave you feeling tired and hungry.

- If you crave something sweet, try and eat some low sugar carrot cake.

Example Breakfast For Photoshoot

Rice Cakes, White Fish (Steamed Cod)
White Rice, Peanut Butter

Example Breakfast For Photoshoot 2

Eggs, Potato's, Cottage Cheese & Orange Juice

Mistakes To Avoid

Cutting Carbs Before Peaking For Your Contest Or Photoshoot

If you remove **carbohydrates**, your muscles will have no glycogen which will make you look flat.

Glycogen can take 3 days to restore after cutting carbs, so take this 3 day rule into account when you consider

removing carbs before a **contest** or photoshoot.

Eating Too Much Carbohydrates The Day Before Your Contest

You will get **water retention** and look puffy. A **balanced** diet of all three macros with examples mentioned above is a better option than an **extreme** style of eating.

Limiting Water, Sodium & Consuming Excess Potassium

Water retention is where you hold water under your skin.

It **destroys definition.** Many people stop drinking water and cut out

sodium days or weeks before. Some take potassium and diuretics.

These all don't really work as well as you would think, potassium leads to stomach upsets, sodium is needed for your electrolytes and a deficiency will dehydrate you causing you to retain more water.

Not to mention your muscles are 75% water, so if you dehydrate them, they will be flat.

This means:

Extreme loading of potassium

= ***not optimal***

Extreme cutting of sodium

= ***not optimal***

Extremely limiting water

= ***not optimal***

All of the **issues** can be fixed by following the example meal plans for the photoshoot / competition prep week period, whereby you stick to white fish, white rice and peanut butter / cottage cheese.

Manage your sodium levels by leaving your food unsalted, do not add salt to the food.

However your body will still **maintain** sodium by processing the **natural salts** in the food choices supplied to you.

In terms of **water,** keep your intake strong, and then on the day, take small sips or 1 to 2 glasses in the morning.

Maintaining **3L** of water for at least a week before is a good bet for the average person.

Water makes your muscles look full. You will need the loo a lot the first few days, then it will become easy.

This is the key to pumping your muscles up.

Example Cutting Meal Plan 2 (Single Digit Body Fat):

Breakfast:

Protein Yoghurt

Pre Workout Snack:

Casein Protein Shake

Lunch:

Omelette and Salad

Dinner:

Chicken Vegetable Soup

Example Cutting Meal Plan 3 (Full 7 Day Plan For Competition Or Photoshoot Week)

7 Days Out (Moderate Carbs)

Breakfast:

Egg Whites
1 whole Egg
Spinach
1/2 cup oats.

Lunch:

Chicken Breast
Asparagus

Dinner:

White Fish
Broccoli

Snack:

Tuna
Salad

6 Days Out

Breakfast:

Egg Whites
1 whole Egg
Spinach
1/2 cup oats.

Lunch:

Grilled Chicken
Quinoa
Roasted Broccoli

Dinner:

Salmon
Sweet potato
Asparagus

Snack:

Greek Yoghurt
Handful Of Berries

5 Days Out (Carb Depletion Phase)

Breakfast:

Egg whites
1 whole egg
Spinach, or cooked zucchini or bell peppers

Lunch:

Turkey breast
Cauliflower rice
Green beans

Snack:

Casein shake or cottage cheese

Dinner:
Grilled White Fish
Roasted Zucchini or Yellow Squash

3 Days Out (Carb Load Phase)

Breakfast:

Egg whites
1 whole egg
Small portion white rice or oats

Snack:

Rice cakes with almond butter or a protein shake

Lunch:

Chicken breast
White Rice
Steamed Carrots

Dinner:

Lean Beef or Chicken
White Rice
Green Beans

2 Days Out

Breakfast:

Egg whites

1 whole egg
Small portion white rice or oats

Lunch:

Steamed Cod
White Rice
Asparagus

Snack:

Cashew Nuts
70% Dark Chocolate

Dinner:
Chicken Breast
Iceberg Lettuce

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1 Day Out (Night Before)

Breakfast:

Egg whites
1 whole egg
Small portion white rice or oats

Lunch:

Steamed Cod
White Rice
Zucchini

Snack:
Cashew Nuts
70% Dark Chocolate

Dinner:

Chicken Breast
Iceberg Lettuce

Show Day:

Breakfast:

Rice Cakes
White Fish (Steamed Cod)
White Rice
Peanut Butter

Broccoli is avoided on show day due to it affecting the look of your abs. The fiber draws in water which affects the separation and definition of your abs.

As you can see, the **meals** on preparation week mostly include white rice, steamed fish, lean beef, chicken and turkey.

There **isn't** any **fried** foods, and the vegetables are **low bloat** vegetables, namely spinach, zucchini, and asparagus.

Sugary **snacks** include 70% dark chocolate, or some raw honey at most.

Should I Take Breakfast?

I personally **don't** have breakfast on at least 50% of my days when I diet, and whilst this does not work for everyone, I will explain my reason why I think it can **help** you.

Provided your body handles it well, skipping breakfast can be an **effective** tool to cut weight.

I prefer to skip breakfast as I believe it is better to avoid triggering the hunger response early in my day. As mentioned in an earlier section, it falls under the intermittent fasting technique.

I feel more **focused** when fasting, and there is no risk of a mood crash. This allows me to be productive in the early parts of the day.

In terms of **losing** weight, it really helps. If you start eating early in the day, you can eat a lot of food before you sleep.

Your body has time to digest numerous meals and get hungry again. I've found if I can hold on until 2 or 3 pm, and then eat, by the time that meal digests, I will likely only

have space for a dinner and be asleep by the time my last meal digests.

My stomach will be full and I will simply fall asleep before it has time to make space again.

This results in eating 2 meals a day instead of 3 less food overall.

From the clients I have trained, any who used this method got an **aesthetic body** very **fast**.

The strategy is to wake up, and drink nothing but **water** or black coffee with no cream or sugar.

Try to delay your first meal until 2 or 3pm. At this stage you only have a few hours left being awake, and your stomach can only hold so much food.

Have a protein rich meal at 2 - 3pm such as a protein shake or protein yoghurt to break your fast. Protein keeps you full for longer. This lets you continue to avoid carbs and avoids spiking cravings.

Have your big, balanced meal at night, and fall asleep full, consuming less calories than you would have otherwise!

Cutting Tips

Volume Eating

Volume eating is a technique where you take food that is really **large** in **size** but **low** in **calories**, in order to fill up your stomach.

This makes you feel **full**, so you eat less calories overall in a day.

There are some great foods for this. Have you ever looked at mushrooms, for example?

An entire pack of mushrooms is **massive**, eating the whole pack would fill up your entire stomach.

If you looked at the calories of that entire pack, it would be around **37 calories.**

This is why vegetables and salads can be really good, they can fill you up without adding lots of calories.

Other examples are **unflavored popcorn**, and **carbonated water.**

Even the zero calorie fizzy drinks can fill up your stomach, however note they contain artificial sweeteners which should not be consumed in large amounts.

Metamucil (psylium husk caps) is also an appetite suppressant. This is a fibre supplement that can lower your hunger.
Rice cakes are great. Water based foods like **cucumber** work too.

Broccoli combined with zero calorie low sugar BBQ sauce can work.

Carrots, apples and bananas are also examples of volume eating low calorie foods.

I have found **psychologically** that chewing gum can help, and even jelly.

Even though jelly is water, it gives the illusion of eating something solid and filling.

I once spoke to a competitive bodybuilder who did 3 hour workouts and competed at a very low body fat percentage weight. He was reaching single digit body fat.

He used Casein protein (slow release protien) and psyllium husk caps (fiber) and eggs mostly.

His reasoning was eggs are very slow to digest, casein is slow to digest, and whey is very fast to digest. And that the caps suppressed appetite.

So he took **casein** instead of whey for his protein shake, psyllium husks and eggs mostly in combination with

volume eating leafy greens and lots of soups.

He also said that low calorie greek yogurt was useful. A whole tub is less than 300 calories and “you will definitely feel full when eating over a pound of yoghurt.”

Yoghurts, soups, casein protein and eggs can be very **effective** alongside chicken breast to get through the last, difficult stages of a cut.

Chicken and **white rice**, **sweet potatoes** and **white fish** are all good, clean food, but experiment with what causes you the most hunger in a food diary and try to steer your diet to one that allows you to eat low calorie whilst not feeling as hungry!

Start to structure your **shopping lists** to reflect these foods when on a cut!

Cutting, Bulking and Maintenance Summary

As you can see, **cutting** is generally for those that want to **lose fat** and get to an optimal body fat percentage.

It works best for those who are motivated, are **mentally ready** to cut, and who have low diet fatigue and low gym fatigue.

Bulking is for those that want to **build muscle**, who are already at a healthy body fat percentage.

They also don't have many up and coming photoshoots or sports games where bulking could interfere.

Maintenance is for those that have a high diet and gym fatigue and need to recover it before a bulk or cut, as well as those that are happy with their physique and wish to **maintain** it with slower progress.

The secret to losing weight:

- Try not to have your first meals until later in the day
- After 2pm, eat a high protein meal
- Focus on protein and fiber to feel full

- Avoid trigger foods and fast release carbs that cause cravings.
- Make use of the volume eating techniques in this chapter
- Drink lots of water
- Follow the clean diet plans provided
- The truth is, with the above techniques and discipline, that is all there is to it.

Eating disorders

A quick note on eating disorders: If you ever train or come across someone who has an **eating disorder**, or who has previously suffered with disordered eating, it is recommended

not to focus on that side of advising someone unless you are a **trained professional.**

Try to train this person **physically**, getting the best out of them, whilst trying to get them referred to a professional if they ask for advice on such **advanced** topics!

This is because it is a **sensitive** subject and better approached by a qualified person who knows what they are doing.

Final Thoughts

We have covered a lot of ground in this small book. Congratulations for reading it — you now know more about nutrition than **90% of people.**

To keep it simple, these are the priorities that will get you the most results:

- Your workout programme
- Reaching your protein intake
- Vitamin D3, cod liver oil, and zinc and magnesium (I am biased towards Vitamins because they make me feel in a good mood, and this gives me energy to stick to my diet.)
- Eating generally clean foods to avoid rapid fat gain

Things like your fibre intake, an extra litre of water, or a creatine supplement are useful, but they matter far less than the **foundations** above. Get those right first.

That said, this chapter has given you many small ideas you can keep coming back to.

Each one might only make a **1% difference** on its own — but thirty or forty of those small improvements add up to a genuinely different body and a genuinely different life.

My final point is this. If you give healthy eating a real chance, over time you will see a change not just in your body but in your **mind**.

After a few months you will not want to go back. Your energy levels will change. Your mood will change. I would eat healthily even if it made no difference visually to my body— simply for how it makes me **feel** day to day.

No crashes, no brain fog. Just a clear mind, and a concentration that can work wonders for focusing on business, handling difficult life situations, and working towards a bright future.

You will get a sense of pride from looking after your body and what you put into it, which is a very healthy mindspace to be in, it can **boost your self esteem** by a lot.

This healthy eating attitude helps you build a type of **love** for your body. You will be more likely to avoid common mistakes others will make such as smoking, drinking too often, and partying too hard.

I even started to **enjoy** cooking and creating healthy meals, and that is something I never expected.

I hope this chapter inspires you to **achieve the best you possibly can with your nutrition!** You will need your nutrition to be on point to get the best results from the workout programs which we will move onto in the second book.

If you ever want help with your nutrition, feel free to send us a DM on Instagram.

We do one-to-one **online** coaching and we also have **video courses** where we walk you through cooking the meals and even take you around the supermarket so you can see exactly what we buy and why. It is nice to have alongside this book.

Finally, we can get you to fill in some **initial nutrition assessment** forms, where our team will take a high level analysis of your nutrition and eating habits to give you feedback, so you can be sure you are on the right track.

This brings us to the end of the Nutrition book. You should be proud of yourself for reading everything so far.

In the second part of the AG Training Edition series, we have a lot to cover, because we will cover your fitness training with one of the most complete fitness systems ever!

Until then, put the ideas of this book into practice, and you will achieve greatness in your nutrition!

“The only person you are destined to become is the person you decide to be.” ~ Ralph Waldo Emerson

“Go confidently in the direction of your dreams.” ~ Henry David Thoreau

“Small disciplines repeated with consistency every day lead to great achievements gained slowly over time.” ~ John C. Maxwell

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